

Confident English (B2 Upper-Intermediate)

Your English notebook for the whole course. Refine your grammar, widen your vocabulary, argue and persuade, and track what you can do.

8 modules • 24 lessons

Words • grammar • speaking • I can...

Name: _____

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Narrating & Looking Back

Tell stories in layers, not in a straight line. Imagine how things could have turned out differently. Then talk about wishes, small regrets and preferences: *I wish I'd set an alarm. I'd rather walk. It's high time we fixed the printer.*

Lessons 1.1-1.3

Classes C1-C3

Level B2

Name: _____

WELCOME TO B2!

At B2 you already have the grammar for most situations. Now you'll work on **range and nuance**: combining tenses to tell a richer story, choosing the exact form for what you mean, arguing a point, and adjusting how formal you sound. Mistakes are a normal part of trying something more ambitious.

Every class: bring this workbook. **At home:** do the online lesson for each class (every lesson has  Listen buttons) and write two sentences in your journal.

Icons:  Write •  Listen •  Say •  Work with a partner •  Read

This module is about looking back, so your stories and wishes are **your** choice. Talk about **small, everyday things** in your real life, **or** use a new identity card, **or** invent something. All are good. You can always say "Pass."

NEW WORDS — TELLING A STORY



nervous



worried



excited

an anecdote = a short, true (or true-sounding) story about something that happened · **a mix-up** = a mistake where two things get confused · **a near miss** = something bad almost happened · **relieved** = happy because a worry is over · **it turned out (that)...** = in the end, we learned that...

Sequencing words to make the order clear:

By the time...

while / as

when

already

just

until

by then

before / after

Storytelling phrases:

You'll never guess what happened...

All of a sudden,...

To make things worse,...

Luckily,...

It turned out that...

In the end,...

GRAMMAR BOX

Four past tenses, four jobs in a story:

Past simple	the main events , in order	She opened the door.
Past continuous	background in progress · was / were + <i>-ing</i>	The rain was falling outside.
Past perfect	an earlier event · had + past participle	Someone had broken the window.
Past perfect continuous	how long an activity had been going on · had been + <i>-ing</i>	They'd been arguing for hours.

had done	a finished action, or a number	By noon she'd written three emails.
had been doing	the activity and its duration, or the cause of a result	Her eyes were tired. She'd been reading all morning.
State verbs	<i>know, be, have (own), want, like, believe</i> stay simple	I'd known him for years. ❌ I'd been knowing him

while / as + a long background action (past continuous) · **when** + the short action that interrupts it (past simple): *While I was cooking, the phone rang.*

Use the past perfect when the order matters. With **before** and **after**, the past simple is often enough: *After I finished, I left.* ✓

🔹 🗣️ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN: THE WRONG TRAIN. WRITE THE VERBS.

Your teacher tells a short story. First, answer: **Why was the speaker late?** _____

1. Last Saturday I _____ to my friend Leo's birthday lunch.
2. I _____ forward to it all week.
3. I _____ on the train when I noticed it was going the wrong way.
4. I _____ the express train by mistake!
5. By the time I got off, I _____ twenty minutes in the wrong direction.
6. I _____ so carefully that...
7. ...I _____ any of the announcements.
8. When I called Leo, they _____ eating.

🗣️ Which verbs are **background**? Which are **earlier** events? Tell a partner.

🔹 ✎ EXERCISE 2 – CHOOSE THE NARRATIVE TENSE

Put the verb in the best past tense.

1. When we arrived, the movie _____ (already / start).
2. She was tired because she _____ (work) all day.
3. While I _____ (drive) home, I saw an accident.
4. By the time he retired, he _____ (work) there for 30 years.
5. I _____ (not meet) her before that evening.
6. The phone _____ (ring) while I was taking a shower.
7. We _____ (walk) for three hours when it started to snow.
8. When I opened the box, I saw that someone _____ (eat) all the cookies.

🔹 ✎ EXERCISE 3 – SIMPLE OR CONTINUOUS? CIRCLE THE BETTER FORM.

1. By noon, Maria **had written** / **had been writing** six emails.
2. Her eyes were tired because she **had read** / **had been reading** all morning.
3. I **had known** / **had been knowing** my neighbor for years before I learned her last name.
4. The kitchen smelled wonderful. Dad **had cooked** / **had been cooking** since lunchtime.
5. By the end of the day, the team **had painted** / **had been painting** three rooms.
6. We were soaking wet because we **had waited** / **had been waiting** in the rain for the bus.

 EXERCISE 4 – SEQUENCING WORDS

Complete with: **by the time** · **while** · **when** · **already** · **just** · **until**

1. _____ I was cooking dinner, my brother called.
2. _____ we reached the theater, the show had started.
3. I had _____ sat down when the doorbell rang.
4. We stayed inside _____ the rain had stopped.
5. She was reading quietly _____ the lights suddenly went out.
6. When I got to the store, it had _____ closed.

 EXERCISE 5 – FROM FLAT TO LAYERED

This story is correct, but flat. Rewrite it with a **background** (past continuous), an **earlier event** (past perfect), and a **duration** (past perfect continuous). Add one sequencing word.

I got to work. My boss was angry. The meeting started at nine. I missed it.

 DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

A: You'll never guess what happened on Tuesday.

B: Go on. What?

A: I'd been working on a big report all afternoon, and I was just finishing the last page when the power went out.

B: Oh no! Had you saved it?

A: That's the thing. I hadn't saved it for about two hours.

B: So you'd lost everything?

A: I thought so! I was sitting there in the dark, feeling terrible, when my coworker came over. She'd been having the same problem for weeks, so she knew the trick.

B: What trick?

A: The program saves a copy every ten minutes. By the time the lights came back on, she'd already found my report. I was so relieved!

 Find one example of each tense: past simple _____ · past continuous _____ · past perfect _____ · past perfect continuous _____

 SPEAKING – STORY RECONSTRUCTION

 Your group gets 8 strips from a story. Put them in order. The tenses and the sequencing words are your clues.

Our story: A • The Wedding Cake ☐ B • Locked Out ☐ Our order: _____

 Now turn the strips over and retell the story from **another person's point of view** (look at your retell card). Use:

- ◆ ☐ two **had been + -ing**: "I'd been driving since six that morning..."
- ◆ ☐ two sequencing words: *by the time, while, when, already, just...*
- ◆ ☐ one feeling: *nervous, worried, relieved, excited*

◆ MY ANECDOTE PLANNER (HOMEWORK)

Plan a **small** memorable story: a mix-up, a funny surprise, a near miss, a day when everything went wrong (or right). Real, from a new identity card, or invented. Write notes, not sentences. Then tell it out loud (or record it) in about 2 minutes.

The main events (past simple)	
The background (past continuous)	
What had happened before (past perfect)	
How long something had been going on (had been + -ing)	
Sequencing words I'll use	

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

"When I got to the airport, the plane ____." The plane left before I arrived. Which is correct?

A) had already taken off

B) took off

C) was taking off

2

"She was exhausted because she ____ all night." Choose the best form to stress duration.

A) had been studying

B) studied

C) has been studying

3

Which sentence is correct?

A) I had been knowing him for ten years when we finally met in person.

B) I had known him for ten years when we finally met in person.

C) I was knowing him for ten years when we finally met in person.

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ name the job of each narrative tense: event, background, earlier event, duration
- ◆ ☐ use **had been + -ing** for how long something had been going on
- ◆ ☐ choose *had done* or *had been doing*, and keep state verbs simple
- ◆ ☐ make the order clear with *by the time*, *while*, *when*, *already*, *just*, *until*
- ◆ ☐ retell a story from another person's point of view

◆  MY NEW WORDS

◆  MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write the first two sentences of a small story, using three different past tenses. Underline each verb and label its job.

1.2 The Third Conditional — What Could Have Happened

Class C2

NEW WORDS — IMAGINING A DIFFERENT PAST

a **turning point** = a moment after which things change · a **chain reaction** = one event causes the next, and the next... · **by chance** = without a plan · **in hindsight** = looking back, with what I know now · a **silver lining** = something good in a bad situation · **It's a good thing (that)...** = I'm glad that...

Phrase bank:

If I had known,...

I would have...

You could have...!

We might have...

If only I'd...

If I hadn't..., I wouldn't be... now

Things would have been different if...

I never would have...

GRAMMAR BOX

The third conditional imagines the **opposite of what really happened**. It can't change now.

Reality	I didn't leave early. I missed the train.
Third conditional	If I had left early, I would have caught the train.
Form	If + had + past participle , ... would have + past participle
Other order	I would have caught the train if I'd left early. (no comma)

would have	certain	If we'd left earlier, we would have caught it.
could have	it was possible	If we'd left earlier, we could have caught it.
might have	maybe, not sure	If we'd left earlier, we might have caught it.

Can it still change? Yes → second conditional: *If I **had** money, I'd **travel**.* · No → third: *If I'd **had** money, I'd **have traveled**.*

Mixed: past → now	If + had + pp, ... would + base verb	If I'd taken that job, I would be rich now .
Mixed: always → past	If + past simple / were , ... would have + pp	If I were more careful, I wouldn't have lost my keys.

We say **would've** /'wʊdəv/, and it sounds like "would of." But we always **write** *would have* or *would've*. ❌
would of · ❌ If I would have known

EXERCISE 1 — LISTEN: THE PICNIC THAT WASN'T

Your teacher tells a story. First write two things that **really** happened:

a) _____ b) _____

Now complete the sentences. Use the verbs in parentheses.

1. If we _____ (check) the forecast, we _____ (not plan) a picnic.
2. If we _____ (bring) an umbrella, we _____ (not get) so wet.
3. If we _____ (not go) into the café, we _____ (not meet) Leo.
4. If we _____ (not meet) Leo, we _____ (not be) friends again now.

 Sentence 4 is different. Why? _____

 EXERCISE 2 – PUT IT IN THE THIRD CONDITIONAL

1. If I _____ (know) it was your birthday, I _____ (buy) a cake.
2. She _____ (not miss) the flight if she _____ (set) an alarm.
3. If they _____ (listen) to the guide, they _____ (not get) lost.
4. We _____ (win) the game if the referee _____ (not make) that call.
5. If you _____ (ask) me, I _____ (help) you move.
6. If the store _____ (be) open, I _____ (can / buy) some milk.

 EXERCISE 3 – SECOND OR THIRD CONDITIONAL?

Can the situation still change? Complete the sentence and write **2nd** or **3rd**.

1. I don't speak Japanese. If I _____ (speak) Japanese, I'd read that book. → _____
2. I didn't save the file. If I _____ (save) it, I wouldn't have lost my work. → _____
3. We're not rich. If we _____ (be) rich, we'd buy a boat. → _____
4. You didn't warn me. If you _____ (warn) me, I would have been careful. → _____
5. The bus is always late. If it _____ (come) on time, I _____ (not need) to leave so early. → _____
6. The bus was late yesterday. If it _____ (come) on time, I _____ (not miss) the start of the movie. → _____

 EXERCISE 4 – WOULD, COULD OR MIGHT? CIRCLE THE BEST WORD.

1. I'm sure about this: if we'd taken a taxi, we **would** / **might** have arrived on time.
2. If I'd asked her, she **would** / **might** have said yes. I'm really not sure.
3. You didn't tell me you needed a ride! I had my car, so I **could** / **would** have picked you up. (It was possible.)
4. You **could** / **might** have called! I was worried all night.
5. If he hadn't been so tired, he **would** / **might** have enjoyed the party more. Who knows?

 EXERCISE 5 – BUILD A MIXED CONDITIONAL

Decide the time of the cause and the time of the result. Then write one sentence.

1. I didn't learn to drive. That's why I'm not independent now. → _____
2. He isn't organized. That's why he forgot the meeting yesterday. → _____
3. Mia took a free cooking class two years ago. That's why she runs a food truck today. → _____
4. I stayed up until 2 a.m. last night. That's why I'm so tired now. → _____
5. Sam is very shy. That's why he didn't speak at yesterday's meeting. → _____

 DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

A: I still can't believe we missed the concert. If we hadn't taken the highway, we would've gotten there in time.

B: Honestly, you could have checked the traffic before we left. I did say something felt wrong.

A: I know, I know. If you'd told me you were worried, I would've listened.

B: Well, if I were a bit more assertive, I probably would've insisted. So it's on both of us.

A: True. And if we'd left even ten minutes earlier, we might have made it anyway.

B: If only we had! Still, if we hadn't gotten lost, we wouldn't be sitting in this great little café right now. Silver lining.

 Find: a *could have* criticism _____ · a *might have* _____ · a mixed conditional about **now** _____

 SPEAKING – CHAIN OF CONSEQUENCES

 Your group has a **start card**. Each new link starts with the **result** of the last one:

Ana's alarm didn't go off. → If Ana's alarm **had gone** off, she **wouldn't have missed** the bus. → If she **hadn't missed** the bus, she **wouldn't have walked** through the park. → ...

After 4 links, turn over the **ending card**. Reach it in 3–4 more links. The **last link** is a mixed conditional: ...*she wouldn't be running a food truck today!*

 Write our best link here: _____

 SMALL TURNING POINTS (HOMEWORK)

Choose **one**: ☐ small turning points in my life (a hobby I started, a class I chose, an app or phone I bought, a friend I met by chance at work or in class) · ☐ my new identity card · ☐ an invented person. Write 4–5 sentences. Use at least one third conditional, one mixed conditional, and one *could have* or *might have*. Keep it small: you don't need to write about big life decisions.

Example: *Three years ago a coworker invited me to a salsa class. If she hadn't invited me, I would never have tried dancing. If I hadn't gone, I wouldn't have so many new friends now!*

SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which sentence is written correctly?

A) If I had seen it, I would have told you.

B) If I had seen it, I would of told you.

C) If I would have seen it, I told you.

2

"I didn't take the job in Berlin. If I ____ it, I ____ living in Germany now."

A) had taken ... would be

B) had taken ... would have been

C) took ... would be

3

Your friend didn't tell you about a big sale, and you missed it. You're annoyed. What do you say?

A) You could have told me!

B) You could told me!

C) You could of told me!

✓ I CAN...

- ☐ form the third conditional: If I had..., I would have...
- ☐ "flip" a third conditional to find what really happened
- ☐ choose would have, could have or might have
- ☐ choose the second or third conditional ("Can it still change?")
- ☐ link a past cause to a present result with a mixed conditional

- ◆ ☐ write *would have / would've*, never "would of"

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write one small fact from your week. Then write it as a third conditional and as a mixed conditional.

NEW WORDS — WISHES AND COMPLAINTS

overdue = it should have happened already · **to put something off** = to delay it · **to get around to (doing) something** = to finally find time for it · **to be fed up with** = to be tired of and annoyed by something · **a habit** = something you do often, without thinking · **a complaint / a suggestion**

Phrase bank:

I wish I had...

I wish I'd...

If only...!

I wish you wouldn't...

I'd rather... than...

I'd rather not.

I'd rather you didn't...

Would you rather...?

It's time we...

It's high time...

It's about time...

It's time to...

GRAMMAR BOX

One trick: a **past form** can mean **unreal** or **not yet**.

Present wish	wish / if only + past simple (or <i>could, were</i>)	I wish I had more time. (I don't.)
Past regret	wish / if only + past perfect	I wish I had set an alarm. (I didn't.)
Annoyance	wish + someone / something else + would	I wish the printer would work!

✗ I wish I would exercise more. → ✓ I wish I exercised more. / I wish I could find the time.

I'd rather + base verb	my preference	I'd rather walk than wait for the bus.
I'd rather + someone + past simple	what I want someone else to do (now / later)	I'd rather you didn't call after ten.
It's time + subject + past simple	it should happen now	It's time we left .
It's high / about time + past simple	it's overdue (a little annoyed)	It's high time they fixed the elevator.
It's time to + base verb	no person named	It's time to go .

hope = possible: *I hope you pass!* · **wish** = unreal: *I wish I'd studied more.*

EXERCISE 1 — LISTEN: THE OFFICE KITCHEN

Two coworkers, Ana and Joe, are in the office kitchen. Complete what they say. Then write **N** (about now) or **P** (about the past).

1. Ana: "I wish I _____ my own lunch today." _____
2. Joe: "I wish people _____ the microwave after they use it." _____
3. Ana: "I wish we _____ a bigger fridge." _____
4. Joe: "If only I _____ the coffee yesterday!" _____
5. Ana: "It's high time the company _____ a new coffee machine." _____
6. Joe: "I _____ go to the café across the street than drink this." _____
7. Ana: "I'd rather _____ the manager together." _____

 EXERCISE 2 – PRESENT WISH OR PAST REGRET?

1. I don't earn much. → I wish I _____ (earn) more.
2. I didn't take that job offer. → I wish I _____ (take) that job offer.
3. You're not here with me. → If only you _____ (be) here.
4. We told them our secret. → I wish we _____ (not tell) them.
5. I can't play an instrument. → I wish I _____ (can) play the piano.
6. She missed the last train. → She wishes she _____ (not miss) it.
7. I didn't bring a jacket, and it's freezing. → I wish I _____ (bring) a jacket.
8. My apartment is so small. → I wish my apartment _____ (be) bigger.

 EXERCISE 3 – REWRITE WITH I WISH... OR IF ONLY...

1. If I had saved more money, I could have traveled. → I wish _____
2. I ate too much, and now I feel sick. → I wish _____
3. We didn't book a table, so we couldn't get in. → If only _____
4. I forgot her birthday. → I wish _____
5. My roommate never closes the door. It's so annoying! → I wish my roommate _____
6. It keeps raining, and I want to go outside. → I wish it _____

 EXERCISE 4 – WOULD RATHER OR IT'S TIME?

1. I'd rather _____ (walk) than take the bus.
2. I'd rather you _____ (not park) in front of my garage.
3. It's high time the building manager _____ (do) something about the elevator.

4. It's time we _____ (go). It's getting dark.
5. Would you rather I _____ (call) you or emailed you?
6. I'd rather not _____ (talk) about it right now.
7. It's time _____ (start) the meeting.

 EXERCISE 5 – FIND THE MISTAKE. WRITE THE CORRECT SENTENCE.

1. I wish I would sleep earlier. → _____
2. It's time we leave. → _____
3. I'd rather you don't go. → _____
4. I wish I would have studied. → _____
5. I'd rather to stay home tonight. → _____
6. I wish you will pass your driving test! (You think it's possible.) → _____

 DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

Nadia: You look exhausted.

Tom: I am. I wish I hadn't stayed up so late finishing that report. If only I'd started it on Monday like you told me.

Nadia: Ha! It's high time you learned to plan ahead.

Tom: I know, I know. But honestly, I wish my manager wouldn't give me things at the last minute.

Nadia: Fair. So, lunch? There's that new Thai place.

Tom: To be honest, I'd rather just grab a sandwich and sit outside. I'd rather we didn't spend an hour waiting in line.

Nadia: Deal. And it's about time we caught up properly. I feel like I never see you.

Tom: Same. I wish I had more free weekends. OK, it's time we got going before the good tables fill up.

 Tom says "I wish" three times. Which one is about the past? _____ Which one is a complaint about someone else? _____

 SPEAKING – WOULD YOU RATHER? AND THE WISH LIST MEETING

 **Would You Rather?** Answer in two sentences: "I'd rather ... **than** ... because..." Then answer the follow-up: "I'd rather you ..." "I'd rather not say!" is always OK.

 **Wish List Meeting.** Your group has a place (an apartment building, an office, a park, our classroom) and a role. Prepare your sentences, then agree on the **top 3 changes**.

Present wish

I wish _____

Present wish	If only _____
Regret about a past decision	I wish they hadn't _____
Overdue	It's high time _____
Preference	I'd rather they _____
Polite disagreement	I see your point, but _____

Our top 3: 1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

MY WISHES & PREFERENCES (HOMEWORK)

Write six sentences about **everyday things**: a habit, something you bought, your week, your street, your workplace, or this class. Or use your new identity card, or an invented person. Small things only: you never have to write about anything you don't want to.

- ◆ ☐ wish / if only + past perfect (a small regret)
- ◆ ☐ wish + past simple (a present wish)
- ◆ ☐ I'd rather + base verb (my preference)
- ◆ ☐ I'd rather + someone + past simple
- ◆ ☐ it's (high / about) time + past simple
- ◆ ☐ one more of my choice

SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

You didn't apply for the scholarship, and now you regret it. Which sentence expresses that past regret?

A) I wish I had applied for the scholarship.

B) I wish I applied for the scholarship.

C) I wish I would apply for the scholarship.

2

You want your roommate to do the dishes more often, starting now. "It's high time you ____ the dishes."

A) washed

B) wash

C) had washed

3

Your neighbor plays loud music every night. Which sentence is correct?

A) I'd rather you didn't play your music so loud at night.

B) I'd rather you don't play your music so loud at night.

C) I'd rather you not to play your music so loud at night.

◆  I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ make a present wish: I wish I had more time.
- ◆ ☐ express a past regret: I wish I'd set an alarm. If only I hadn't...
- ◆ ☐ complain about someone else's habit: I wish you wouldn't...
- ◆ ☐ say my preference: I'd rather walk than...
- ◆ ☐ say what I want someone else to do: I'd rather you didn't...
- ◆ ☐ say something is overdue: It's high time they fixed...

◆  MY NEW WORDS

◆  MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write one small regret from this week. Then turn it into a plan: "I wish I'd..., so from tomorrow I'll..."

MODULE 1 — WELL DONE! 🎉

You can tell a story in layers, imagine how the past could have been different, and talk about wishes, small regrets and preferences. Look at your three "I can..." lists. Is a box empty? Tell your teacher. Practice at home with online lessons 1.1, 1.2 and 1.3 and the 📶 buttons.

Verb Patterns & Modality

Small words, big differences. *I stopped to buy coffee* and *I stopped buying coffee* mean opposite things. *They must have left* and *They might have left* show how sure you are. *I used to...*, *I'm used to...* and *I'm getting used to...* describe the past, the present and change. In this module you'll learn to choose exactly the one you mean.

Lessons 2.1-2.3

Classes C4-C6

Level B2

Name: _____

ICONS

 Write ·  Listen ·  Say ·  Work with a partner ·  Read

When a task is about your life, it's **your** choice what to share. You can talk about your real life, **or** use a new identity card, **or** invent something. All are equally good. You can always say "Pass."

NEW WORDS — HABITS, GOALS AND FEELINGS ABOUT ACTIVITIES



I enjoy
cooking.



We decided to
go hiking.



I'm learning to
play the
guitar.



I've stopped
swimming.

consider = think about doing · **can't afford** = don't have enough money or time · **manage** = succeed in doing something difficult · **refuse** = say no to doing · **can't stand** = hate · **look forward to** = feel happy about something in the future · **be committed to** = be seriously dedicated to

Useful phrases for talking about yourself:

I really enjoy...ing

I've stopped...ing

I keep...ing

I can't stand...ing

I'm hoping to...

I'm saving up to...

I'm good at...ing

I'm looking forward to...ing

GRAMMAR BOX

verb + -ing	enjoy, avoid, finish, mind, suggest, imagine, consider, keep, practice, miss, can't stand	I don't mind waiting.
verb + to	want, decide, hope, promise, agree, offer, refuse, manage, learn, seem, afford	We can't afford to wait.
preposition + -ing	good at, interested in, tired of, instead of, before, after, without, look forward to	He left without saying goodbye.
-ing as subject	the activity is the subject	Learning a language takes time.
adjective + to	happy, difficult, easy, ready, surprised	It's difficult to explain.
purpose	to + verb (not for + -ing)	I went out to buy milk.
verb + person + to	want, ask, tell, advise, allow, encourage	She encouraged him to apply.
no "to"	after modals and let / make + person	Let me help. · They made him wait.

Is to a preposition? Try a noun after it. "I'm looking forward to the weekend" works, so use -ing: "looking forward to **seeing** you."

Same verb, different meaning: *-ing* looks back (a memory, the activity itself). *to* looks forward (a duty, a purpose, an attempt).

	+ -ing	+ to
remember	I remember locking the door. (a memory)	Remember to lock the door. (a duty)
forget	I'll never forget meeting her. (a memory)	Don't forget to call me. (a duty)
stop	He stopped smoking. (he quit)	He stopped to smoke. (he paused in order to)
try	Try adding salt. (an experiment)	I tried to open it. (an attempt, it was hard)
regret	I regret saying that. (sorry about the past)	We regret to tell you... (bad news now)
go on	She went on talking. (continued)	She went on to talk about money. (next topic)
mean	This job means traveling. (involves)	I meant to call you. (intended)

Little or no change: like, love, hate, prefer, begin, start, continue. "I like swimming" $\approx$ "I like to swim."

🔹 🗣️ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO KAI. COMPLETE THE SENTENCES.

Your teacher reads Kai's message about his new routine. Write the missing verb in the correct form.

1. This year Kai decided _____ his routine.
2. He has stopped _____ up late watching videos.
3. Now he tries _____ in bed by eleven.
4. He goes running in the morning _____ his head.
5. At first he hated _____ up at six, but now he doesn't mind it.
6. He's thinking about _____ a running club.
7. He's looking forward to _____ new people.
8. He avoids _____ expensive gear.
9. He needs to remember _____ his headphones.

🔹 ✎ EXERCISE 2 – -ING OR TO? WRITE THE CORRECT FORM.

1. I really enjoy _____ (cook) on the weekend.
2. She decided _____ (study) medicine.
3. He's very good at _____ (solve) problems.
4. We can't afford _____ (buy) a new car.
5. I'm looking forward to _____ (see) you next week.

6. They made him _____ (apologize).
7. Would you mind _____ (close) the window?
8. I refuse _____ (pay) for a plastic bag.
9. She's committed to _____ (help) new staff.
10. It's difficult _____ (explain) over the phone.

 EXERCISE 3 – WHICH MEANING? WRITE A OR B.

Example: **a** I stopped to buy coffee. · **b** I stopped buying coffee. → I quit the habit: **b**

1. **a** I remember meeting him at the party. · **b** Remember to meet him at the party. → It's a job for later:

2. **a** Try switching it off and on again. · **b** I tried to switch it off, but the button was stuck. → It was difficult:

3. **a** I'll never forget seeing the ocean for the first time. · **b** Don't forget to bring your ID. → It's a memory:

4. **a** I regret telling him my password. · **b** We regret to inform you that the class is canceled. → It's bad news being given now: _____
5. **a** After the break, she went on explaining the rules. · **b** After the break, she went on to explain the new schedule. → She moved to a new topic: _____
6. **a** Working nights means sleeping during the day. · **b** I meant to text you, but I forgot. → It's about an intention: _____
7. **a** On the way home, we stopped to get gas. · **b** We've stopped getting gas at that station. → We paused in order to do it: _____

 EXERCISE 4 – ERROR HUNT. TICK (✓) THE CORRECT SENTENCES. CORRECT THE OTHERS.

1. I'm looking forward to see you on Friday. _____
2. She suggested to take a taxi. _____
3. We went to the store for buying some bread. _____
4. My manager let me leave early. _____
5. To learn a language takes time. _____
6. He's thinking about changing jobs. _____
7. They made us to wait for an hour. _____
8. I want that you call me tomorrow. _____
9. I can't afford to eat out every week. _____

10. She's good in cooking. _____
11. I don't mind to work on Saturdays. _____
12. Would you like to join us? _____

 EXERCISE 5 – BUILD THE SENTENCE

Use a preposition + *-ing* or an infinitive of purpose.

1. Instead of _____, why don't you ask for help? (give up)
2. I'm going to the library _____ a book for my report. (borrow)
3. She's interested _____ for a charity. (volunteer)
4. He turned on the light _____ better. (see)
5. She saves money every month _____ next year. (travel)
6. He left the meeting without _____ a word. (say)

 DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

- A:** So, are you still going to the gym?
- B:** Actually, I've stopped going. I got bored. But I've started running in the mornings instead.
- A:** Nice. I keep meaning to exercise, but I always put off starting.
- B:** Try going with a friend. It helped me. I remember hating it at first, but now I look forward to running.
- A:** Maybe. My goal is to feel fitter by summer. I just need to remember to set my alarm!
- B:** Well, I go at six-thirty. Do you want to come with me on Saturday?
- A:** Six-thirty? I can't stand getting up that early... but OK. I promise to try.

 Underline every verb after another verb or a preposition. Find one **memory** and one **duty**:

 SPEAKING – TWO MINUTES ABOUT ME

 Write **key words only** (real, a new identity card, or invented). Then talk to a partner for two minutes. Your partner asks two follow-up questions.

Habits	I enjoy... · I've stopped... · I keep... · I avoid...	
Goals	I want to... · I'm hoping to... · I'm saving up to...	

Likes & dislikes	I love... · I can't stand... · I'm good at... · I'm tired of...	
+ 1 purpose	I go running to...	
+ 1 meaning change	I remember ...ing · I must remember to...	

◆ 🔊 SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which sentence is correct?

A) I'm tired of to wait.

B) I'm tired of waiting.

C) I'm tired for wait.

2

"On the way home, he stopped ____ a coffee." (He paused in order to get one.)

A) to buy

B) buying

C) for buying

3

Which sentence means "I have a memory of doing it"?

A) I remembered to call my mom.

B) I remember calling my mom on her birthday.

C) I remember to call my mom every Sunday.

◆ ✅ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ use *-ing* after verbs like enjoy, avoid, mind, consider
- ◆ ☐ use *to* after verbs like want, decide, afford, refuse
- ◆ ☐ use *-ing* after any preposition, including *look forward to*

- ◆ ☐ explain why I do things with *to*: I went out to buy milk
- ◆ ☐ say exactly what I mean with remember, forget, stop and try
- ◆ ☐ talk for two minutes about my habits, goals and likes

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write one sentence with *remember + -ing* and one with *remember + to*. Which one is a memory? Which one is a duty?

NEW WORDS — THINKING LIKE A DETECTIVE

evidence = the facts you can see · **a clue** = one small piece of evidence · **a deduction** = a confident guess from evidence · **a verdict** = your final decision · **rule out** = decide something is not possible · **in hindsight** = looking back, now that you know more · **in a hurry** = very quickly, with no time

Detective phrases:

It must have been...

Someone must have...

They can't have...

That couldn't have...

She might have...

He could have...

You should have...

I shouldn't have...

Are you sure?

That rules out...

GRAMMAR BOX

Every past deduction: **modal + have + past participle**. The modal never changes. *have* never becomes *has* or *had*.

~95% sure it happened	must have + pp	The ground's wet. It must have rained.
possible (~50%)	might / may / could have + pp	She might have missed the bus.
possibly not	might not / may not have + pp	Ben may not have gone. He was sick.
~95% sure it didn't	can't / couldn't have + pp	He can't have finished already.

✗ She ~~mustn't~~ have seen us. → ✓ She **can't have** seen us. · ✗ ~~must of / could of / should of~~ → ✓ **must have**

Now	He must be tired. · She can't know .
Past	He must have been tired. · She can't have known .

Judging past choices:

should have + pp	the right thing, but it didn't happen	You should have called me.
shouldn't have + pp	the wrong thing, but it happened	I shouldn't have eaten that.
could have + pp ①	a possibility	Where's Sam? He could have gone home.

could have + pp ②	a missed chance	I could have gone to the concert, but I stayed home.
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◆ ✎ EXERCISE 1 – READ THE CLUE. CHOOSE MUST HAVE, CAN'T HAVE OR MIGHT HAVE.

1. Her English is excellent. She _____ (live) in an English-speaking country.
2. The exam finished ten minutes ago. He _____ (grade) all 200 papers yet!
3. There's no answer. He _____ (go) out, or he _____ (fall) asleep. I'm not sure.
4. All the food is gone and the plates are dirty. The guests _____ (enjoy) the meal.
5. She passed the test without studying? She _____ (be) very lucky!
6. Her coat is still on the hook and her car is in the parking lot. She _____ (leave) the building.
7. Tom got 100% on the test and he can't stop smiling. He _____ (study) really hard.

◆ ✎ EXERCISE 2 – HOW SURE ARE YOU? REWRITE WITH A PAST MODAL.

Example: I'm almost sure it rained last night. → **It must have rained last night.**

1. I'm almost sure she forgot about the meeting. → _____
2. Maybe he took the earlier bus. → _____
3. I'm almost sure they didn't see the sign. → _____
4. It's possible that she didn't get my message. → _____
5. I'm sure it was a mistake. → _____
6. It's impossible that he finished the report in one hour. → _____

◆ 📖 ✎ EXERCISE 3 – CORRECT THE ERROR

1. He mustn't have heard the alarm. He slept right through it. → _____
2. You could of told me the meeting was canceled! → _____
3. She must of been exhausted after that long flight. → _____
4. They mustn't have received the invitation, because nobody came. → _____
5. I should of booked the tickets earlier. → _____
6. He must has forgotten my number. → _____
7. It must have rain last night. The street is wet. → _____

◆ ✎ EXERCISE 4 – REACT WITH SHOULD HAVE, SHOULDN'T HAVE OR COULD HAVE

1. You forgot your umbrella and got soaked. → _____

2. Your friend lent money to someone unreliable and never got it back. → _____
3. You stayed up until 3 a.m. and now you're exhausted at work. → _____
4. A coworker sent an angry email in the heat of the moment. → _____
5. You had a free ticket to a concert, but you stayed home. (a missed chance) → _____
6. Your roommate knew the water would be off today and didn't tell you. → _____

🔹 🗣️ EXERCISE 5 – LISTEN TO THREE PUZZLES. WHAT HAPPENED?

Your teacher reads three short puzzles. For each one, write one **must have** sentence and one **can't have** or **might have** sentence.

Puzzle 1 (Ana's kitchen): _____

Puzzle 2 (Ben's desk): _____

Puzzle 3 (the empty classroom): _____

🔹 📖 🗣️ DIALOGUE – THE OFFICE CAKE MYSTERY

Mia: Look, the cake's gone from the fridge, and there are crumbs all over Dan's desk. He must have eaten it.

Theo: Hold on. Dan left at four for the dentist. He can't have taken it. He wasn't even here at snack time.

Mia: Good point. So someone else might have left those crumbs. Who was here after four?

Theo: Only Priya. And her coffee mug's still warm, so she could have been here five minutes ago.

Mia: But wait, Priya's allergic to chocolate. She couldn't have eaten a whole chocolate cake.

Theo: True. Honestly, we shouldn't have left it in a shared fridge. You should have put your name on it.

Mia: ...The cleaner! He comes at four-thirty. He must have thought it was leftovers and thrown it out. Case closed.

✏️ Find one deduction that says "sure yes," one that says "sure no" and one *should have* judgment. Underline the past participles.

🔹 🗣️ SPEAKING – THE MYSTERY OF ROOM 12 (DETECTIVE NOTES)

🗣️ Read your clues aloud. Don't show your card. Listen to your group and take notes. Then agree on a verdict.

Clue	Deduction (modal + have + pp)	How sure?
the coffee is still warm	They can't have left long ago.	95% ✗

 **Our verdict:** We're almost sure that _____. They can't have _____ . They might have _____. They should have _____ .

 **SELF-CHECK** – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

"The kitchen was spotless when I got home. Someone ____ cleaned it." (You're almost sure.)

A) must have

B) mustn't have

C) can't have

2

Your friend missed a deadline because you never reminded them. Which sentence expresses your regret?

A) I should have reminded you.

B) I must have reminded you.

C) I could of reminded you.

3

Which sentence is correct?

A) She mustn't have seen us.

B) She can't have seen us.

C) She can't has seen us.

 **I CAN...**

- ◆ ☐ say what must have, might have or can't have happened, from clues
- ◆ ☐ show how sure I am with the right modal
- ◆ ☐ avoid "mustn't have" and "could of"
- ◆ ☐ judge past choices with should have and shouldn't have
- ◆ ☐ use could have for a possibility and for a missed chance
- ◆ ☐ reason with a group and give a verdict

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Think of a small, puzzling moment from this week (a late bus, a strange message, a change of plan), real or invented. Write one deduction about why it happened and one *should have* sentence.

NEW WORDS — ADJUSTING TO SOMETHING NEW

adjust / adapt = change to fit a new situation · **a routine** = what you usually do every day · **a commute** = the trip to work or school · **a shift** = your working hours (day shift, night shift) · **settle in** = start to feel comfortable in a new place or job · **a learning curve** = the time it takes to learn something new · **feel at home** = feel relaxed and comfortable

Useful phrases:

I used to...

I didn't use to...

I'm (not) used to...ing

I'm getting used to...

It took me a while to get used to...

I still can't get used to...

You'll soon get used to it.

It takes some getting used to.

GRAMMAR BOX

used to + base verb	a past habit or state, not true now · past only	I used to swim every day.
be used to + noun / -ing	familiar, normal for you · any tense	I'm used to swimming in cold water.
get used to + noun / -ing	becoming familiar, adapting · any tense	I'm getting used to swimming at dawn.

Negative	I didn't use to like coffee. (no d after <i>did</i>)
Question	Did you use to live here?
Now?	✗ I use to jog. → ✓ I usually jog.
get used to	I'm getting used to it. · I got used to it. · You'll get used to it. · I've gotten used to it.

The "it" test: can you say "I'm used to it"? Yes → *to* is a preposition → use a noun or *-ing*. "I used to it"? No → base verb.

EXERCISE 1 — CHOOSE THE STRUCTURE. WRITE THE WHOLE PHRASE.

- When I was a child, I _____ (have) long hair. (past habit, gone)
- Don't worry about the spicy food. You'll _____ (it) after a few days. (adapting in the future)
- She's a nurse, so she _____ (see) blood. It doesn't shock her. (familiar now)

4. It took me ages to _____ (drive) on the highway. (adapted over time)
5. There _____ (be) a movie theater here, but they tore it down. (past state, gone)

 EXERCISE 2 – BASE VERB OR -ING?

1. I used to _____ (play) the piano when I was young.
2. He's used to _____ (work) under pressure.
3. We're getting used to _____ (live) in a smaller apartment.
4. Did you use to _____ (walk) to school?
5. It was hard, but she got used to _____ (get) up at 5 a.m.
6. I didn't use to _____ (like) spicy food.
7. You'll soon get used to _____ (use) the new app.

 EXERCISE 3 – CORRECT THE ERROR

1. I'm used to get up early these days. → _____
2. She didn't used to like her boss. → _____
3. It took me a month to get used to eat with chopsticks. → _____
4. I use to live in Denver ten years ago. → _____
5. Are you used to work on weekends now? → _____

 EXERCISE 4 – LISTEN TO DANA. COMPLETE THE SENTENCES.

Dana works in a hospital lab. Three months ago, she changed to the night shift.

1. Dana used to _____ work at 7 a.m.
2. At first she wasn't used to _____ during the day.
3. With earplugs and dark curtains, she slowly _____ it.
4. Now she _____ having "breakfast" at 6 p.m.
5. She still can't _____ driving home when everyone is driving to work.
6. Her advice: "Give it a month. You'll _____ it."

 Do you agree with Dana's advice? Why or why not?

 EXERCISE 5 – SAY IT WITH USED TO, BE USED TO OR GET USED TO

Example: I lived near the beach as a kid, but I don't now. → **I used to live near the beach.**

1. Early meetings are normal for me now. → _____
2. The new software felt strange at first, but it's slowly becoming normal. → _____
3. Did you have a car when you lived downtown? → _____

4. He found the cold weather difficult, but after a year it was normal for him. →

5. My grandmother never wore jeans in the past, but now she wears them all the time. →

 DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

Grace: So, how's the new job at the warehouse going?

Luis: Good, but it's a big change. I used to work in an office, so I used to sit all day. Now I'm on my feet for eight hours!

Grace: Wow. Are you used to it yet?

Luis: I'm getting used to it. My legs hurt the first week, but now it's fine. The hardest part is the early start. I'm still not used to getting up at four-thirty.

Grace: You'll get used to it. When I started at the bakery, I couldn't get used to going to bed at eight. Now I don't even need an alarm.

Luis: Really? Did you use to be a night owl?

Grace: Totally! I used to stay up until one every night. Now I'm used to being in bed before the news starts.

Luis: That gives me hope. Oh, and they gave us scanners with a new app. It takes some getting used to.

Grace: Give it a month. You'll be so used to it, you'll forget how the old way worked.

 Sort every *used to* in the dialogue: **past** (gone) · **now** (familiar) · **changing** (adapting).

 SPEAKING – ADJUSTING TO SOMETHING NEW

Choose a change: **a new job** · **a new schedule or shift** · **new technology** (a phone, an app, self-checkout) · **a new neighborhood** across town · **a new hobby**. It can be from your life, a change card, your new identity card, or invented.

How things used to be (×2)	I used to... · I didn't use to...	
What's normal now (×2)	I'm used to... · I'm not used to... yet	
Still adapting (×1)	I'm getting used to... · I still can't get used to...	
My advice (×1)	You'll get used to... · It took me... to get used to...	

 Talk for about two minutes. Listeners ask one question each and give one piece of advice.

  SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

"When I first moved here the silence felt strange, but now I ____ it."

A) used to

B) am used to

C) used to be

2

Which sentence uses the correct verb form?

A) I'm used to work long shifts.

B) I'm used to working long shifts.

C) I'm getting used to work long shifts.

3

"She ____ drive a small car, but now she drives a truck for work."

A) is used to

B) used to

C) got used to

  I CAN...

-  ☐ talk about past habits with *used to* and *didn't use to*
-  ☐ say what's normal for me with *be used to* + *noun* / *-ing*
-  ☐ describe adapting with *get used to* + *noun* / *-ing*
-  ☐ use the "it" test to choose the base verb or *-ing*
-  ☐ talk about adjusting to something new and give advice

  MY NEW WORDS

  MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write about a change (real or invented): one thing you're used to now, and one thing you're still getting used to. Check: is there a noun or *-ing* after *to*?

Advanced Structures

Three ways to say more with less. Shift the focus with the passive, and report what people believe in the calm voice of the news. Cut long sentences down to tight, elegant ones. And report other people's words with the one verb that says exactly what they were doing: *she refused*, *he admitted*, *they suggested*.

Lessons 3.1-3.3

Classes C7-C9

Level B2

Name: _____

ICONS

 Write ·  Listen ·  Say ·  Work with a partner ·  Read

When a task is about your life, you decide what to share. Use your real life, **or** a new identity card, **or** something you invent. All three are equally good. In role-plays you play the card, not yourself, and you can always say "Pass."

◆ NEW WORDS — THE LANGUAGE OF THE NEWS

a bulletin

a headline

a rumor

a claim

to confirm

according to...

reportedly

widely (believed)

a record

to be expected to...

🗣️ Useful phrases for formal reporting:

It is widely believed that...

It is generally accepted that...

It has been reported that...

... is thought to be...

... is said to have...

... is expected to...

📖 Services: somebody else does the job for you.

have my car
repaired

have a key cut

get my shoes
repairedhave my
passport
renewed

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

The passive in any tense: change only **be**. The past participle never changes.

Present simple / continuous	It is done . · It is being done .
Past simple / continuous	It was done . · It was being done .
Present / past perfect	It has been done . · It had been done .
Future	It will be done . · It is going to be done .
Modal	It must / can / should be done .
Modal perfect	It should / might / must have been done .

Impersonal reporting passives: report what people believe without saying who. Verbs: *say, think, believe, know, report, expect, consider, understand*.

Active	People say (that) he is very rich.
Pattern A	It is said that he is very rich.
Pattern B	He is said to be very rich.

In Pattern B, the infinitive shows the **timing**:

Same time	to be / to do	He is thought to be rich.
In progress now	to be + -ing	She is thought to be living in Florida.
Earlier	to have + past participle	He is thought to have left the country.

The causative: have / get + object + past participle = someone else does it for you.

✓ I had my car repaired. (a mechanic did it) · ✗ I had repaired my car. (= I repaired it myself, earlier)

🔹 🗣️ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO THE RADIO BULLETIN. COMPLETE THE PASSIVES.

Your teacher reads the three o'clock news from Riverside Community Radio. Write the missing words.

- Shelly, the zoo's oldest tortoise, _____ about 120 years old.
- A piano _____ in the waiting room of the train station on Monday.
- It _____ by a local musician.
- The public _____ not to move it.
- A library book _____ yesterday, fifty years late.
- The book _____ in 1976 by a student.
- A small party _____ at the library on Saturday.

🗣️ Which story would you most like to hear more about? Tell a partner.

🔹 🖋️ EXERCISE 2 – UP THE LADDER. WRITE THE PASSIVE.

Use the tense or modal in brackets.

- The samples _____ in the lab. (analyze — present simple)
- The bridge _____ next year. (build — future *will*)
- All the tickets _____ already. (sell — present perfect)
- This form _____ in black ink. (complete — *must*)
- The report _____ days ago. (finish — *should*, modal perfect)
- The road _____ when we drove past. (repair — past continuous)
- The windows _____ right now. (clean — present continuous)
- The package _____ to the wrong address. (deliver — *might*, modal perfect)

🔹 🖋️ EXERCISE 3 – "PEOPLE SAY THAT...": WRITE IT BOTH WAYS

Write Pattern A (*It... that*) and Pattern B (*Subject... to*).

- People say that the castle is haunted.

A: _____

B: _____

2. Experts believe the economy is recovering.

A: _____

B: _____

3. Reporters reported that the CEO had left the country.

A: _____

B: _____

4. Everyone knows that she was a brilliant scientist.

A: _____

B: _____

5. People think the tortoise is about 120.

A: _____

B: _____

6. They say the singer is living in Canada now.

A: _____

B: _____

 EXERCISE 4 – NOW OR EARLIER? CIRCLE THE CORRECT INFINITIVE.

1. The castle is said (to be built / to have been built) in 1350.

2. The winner is expected (to be announced / to have been announced) tomorrow.

3. She is believed (to be living / to have lived) with her sister at the moment.

4. The thieves are thought (to escape / to have escaped) through a window.

5. He is known (to be / to have been) a great cook. Everyone loves his food.

6. The painting is reported (to be sold / to have been sold) last week for \$2 million.

 EXERCISE 5 – HAVE IT DONE. REWRITE WITH THE CAUSATIVE.

Keep the same tense. Start with the words given.

1. A mechanic serviced my car yesterday. → I _____

2. A hairdresser is cutting her hair right now. → She _____

3. A photographer will take our portraits next week. → We _____

4. Someone stole his bike last night. (bad luck) → He _____

5. A locksmith cut a new key for me this morning. → I _____

6. Someone is going to clean our windows on Friday. → We _____

 DIALOGUE – IN THE NEWSROOM

Editor: OK, what have we got for the four o'clock news?

Reporter: A giant pumpkin at the county fair. Everyone's saying it weighs about a thousand pounds.

Editor: Nice. How would you say that on air?

Reporter: "The pumpkin is thought to weigh about a thousand pounds." Or "It is thought that..."

Editor: Good. Do we know who grew it?

Reporter: Yes, it was grown by Mrs. Olsen, a retired teacher. People say she fed it milk every day.

Editor: That's a rumor, so be careful. Say: "She is said to have fed it milk every day."

Reporter: "To have fed," because the feeding happened before. Got it. It'll be weighed on Saturday, and a new state record is expected.

Editor: Perfect. Anything else?

Reporter: Only that I'd love to have it made into pies.

Editor: Ha! Let's keep that out of the bulletin.

 Underline every passive. Circle the one causative. Which sentence is a rumor, and which are facts?

 SPEAKING — NEWS REPORT REWRITE

 **Warm up: rewrite it formally.** Turn each chatty line into news English.

1. "Everyone says the new bakery uses a 100-year-old recipe." → _____
2. "People think the owner learned to bake in Italy." → _____
3. "They're going to open it next Monday." → _____
4. "They expect long lines on the first day." → _____

 **In class:** you and your partner get one story. A has the **rumors**; B has the **official facts**. Tell each other your half (don't show the card), then write a six-sentence bulletin and read it **on air**, one sentence each.

Headline: _____	
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	
6	

☐ Pattern A (*It is... that*) · ☐ Pattern B (*... is said to...*) · ☐ a modal passive · ☐ another tense (*has been / was being*) · ☐ *to have + pp* for an earlier action

◆ 🔊 SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

"People think the manager left the company last year." Which impersonal passive is correct?

A) The manager is thought to leave the company last year.

B) The manager is thought to have left the company last year.

C) It is thought the manager to have left the company last year.

2

A mechanic fixed your brakes yesterday. Which sentence correctly uses "have something done"?

A) I had fixed my brakes yesterday.

B) I had fix my brakes yesterday.

C) I had my brakes fixed yesterday.

3

"The form ____ yesterday. Now it's too late."

A) should have sent

B) should have been sent

C) should be sent

◆ ✓ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ form the passive in any tense and with modals: *has been done, should have been done*
- ◆ ☐ report a belief in two ways: *It is said that... / He is said to...*
- ◆ ☐ choose *to be, to be doing* or *to have done* for the timing
- ◆ ☐ say that someone did a job for me: *I had my car repaired.*
- ◆ ☐ read a short formal news bulletin on air

◆ ✎ MY NEW WORDS

◆ ✎ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write one "It is said that..." sentence about your town or workplace (real or invented), and one sentence about something you had done recently.

3.2 Fewer Words, Same Meaning — Relative & Participle Clauses

Class C8

NEW WORDS — TIGHT, DESCRIPTIVE WRITING

located near...

built in...

surrounded by...

made of...

written in...

having finished...

not knowing...

feeling (tired)...

a draft

a word limit

concise

to cut / to trim

concise = saying everything that matters in as few words as possible · **a dangling participle** = a participle clause with the wrong subject (a common writing mistake)

GRAMMAR BOX

	Defining	Non-defining
Job	says which one	adds extra information
Commas?	no	yes
that?	OK	never
Example	The woman who lives next door is a doctor.	My sister, who lives next door, is a doctor.

Reduce a defining clause. Ask: does the noun **do** the action, or **receive** it?

Does it → -ing	The man who is standing there · The train that leaves leaving at noon
Receives it → past participle	The letter which was written by John · Products that are made locally

Join two sentences with a participle clause. The subject must be the **same** in both parts.

Time	Walking home, I saw an accident.
Reason	Feeling tired, he went to bed. · Made of glass, it breaks easily.
Negative	Not knowing the way, we got lost.
Earlier action	Having finished work, she went home.

✗ *Walking home, the rain started.* (The rain can't walk!) · ✓ *Walking home, I got caught in the rain.*

Don't reduce one finished past action (*the man **who called** me yesterday*), and keep non-defining clauses full in careful writing.

EXERCISE 1 — LISTEN TO THE OLD TOWN AUDIO TOUR. CIRCLE WHAT YOU HEAR.

- (Built / Building) in 1890, Riverside Station is the oldest building in town.
- The man (standing / stood) by the clock is Albert, our volunteer guide.

3. (Locating / Located) just behind the station, the market has been open every Sunday for a hundred years.
4. On Hill Street you'll see houses (painting / painted) in pale blue and pink.
5. (Having climbed / Climbed) to the top of the hill, most visitors stop for a rest.
6. From there you can see the stalls (selling / sold) fresh bread and flowers.
7. (Surrounding / Surrounded) by trees, the little park is perfect for a picnic.

 EXERCISE 2 – REDUCE THE RELATIVE CLAUSE

Active → **-ing**. Passive → **past participle**.

1. The people who are waiting outside look cold. → _____
2. The email which was sent yesterday never arrived. → _____
3. Any student who fails the test can retake it. → _____
4. The paintings that were stolen in 2004 were finally found. → _____
5. The road that connects the two towns is closed. → _____
6. The man who is repairing our roof is from Ohio. → _____
7. Houses that were built before 1950 often need new windows. → _____

 EXERCISE 3 – COMBINE WITH A PARTICIPLE CLAUSE

Join each pair into one sentence. The clue in brackets tells you the meaning.

1. She didn't feel well. She stayed at home. (reason) → _____
2. He was driving to work. He heard the news on the radio. (time) → _____
3. They had finished dinner. They went for a walk. (sequence) → _____
4. I didn't know his number. I couldn't call him. (reason, negative) → _____
5. The museum is located in the old town hall. It is open every day. (description) → _____
6. She had read the report. She called the team. (sequence) → _____

 EXERCISE 4 – DANGLER DOCTOR. FIX THE SUBJECT.

Who is doing the *-ing* action? Rewrite each sentence so it makes sense.

1. Looking out of the window, the mountains were beautiful. → _____
2. Having eaten too much, the meal made me sleepy. → _____
3. Running for the bus, my bag fell open. → _____
4. Opening the fridge, the milk smelled terrible. → _____
5. Tired after work, the sofa looked very inviting. → _____

 EXERCISE 5 – REDUCE IT, OR KEEP IT?

Write ✓ and the reduced sentence, or ✗ and why not.

1. The people who work in this office are very friendly. _____
2. The man who fixed my sink yesterday was very fast. _____
3. The cake that was made by my neighbor won first prize. _____
4. My brother, who lives in Houston, is visiting next week. _____
5. The movie that we watched last night was boring. _____
6. Passengers who are traveling with children may board first. _____

 DIALOGUE – EDITING THE NEWSLETTER

Nora: Can you look at my notice for the building newsletter? The limit is fifty words and I've got eighty.

Ben: Sure. "The yard sale that is being organized by the tenants' committee will be held on Saturday." Cut it: "The yard sale organized by the tenants' committee..."

Nora: Nice. What about "People who want to sell things should bring their own table"?

Ben: "Anyone wanting to sell things should bring a table." Shorter, and it sounds more like a notice.

Nora: And here: "I finished the draft and then I sent it to Maria."

Ben: "Having finished the draft, I sent it to Maria." Just don't write "Having finished the draft, Maria got an email."

Nora: Ha! Then Maria finished it. OK, last one: "Mrs. Cruz, who lives in 3B, is bringing lemonade."

Ben: Keep that. It's extra information with commas, and it reads better in full.

Nora: Forty-eight words. Done!

 Find two reduced clauses and one participle clause. Which clause did Ben decide **not** to reduce, and why?

 SPEAKING – SENTENCE COMPRESSION WORKSHOP

 **Round 1, strips:** join each set of short sentences into one. Say it first, then write it.

 **Round 2, the Editor's Desk:** your group gets a wordy draft (about 100 words). Cut it to **60 words or fewer**. Every fact must stay. Use at least **4 participle clauses**. No dangles!

Our draft: ☐ A notice · ☐ B museum label · ☐ C mini-biography · ☐ D apartment ad Words: _____

 **Round 3:** read your version to the class. Vote for the **clearest** version, not the shortest.

 **Spot the Difference:** describe your scene to a partner with reduced clauses ("a man **wearing** a red cap **standing** at the bus stop"). Find five differences.

  SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Reduce: "The report which was prepared by the committee is on your desk."

A) The report preparing by the committee is on your desk.

B) The report was prepared by the committee is on your desk.

C) The report prepared by the committee is on your desk.

2

Which sentence has a dangling participle (the wrong subject)?

A) Feeling nervous, she took a deep breath.

B) Sleeping deeply, the alarm didn't wake me.

C) Having finished, we left the room quietly.

3

Which sentence is correct?

A) The books selling here are second-hand.

B) The books sold here are second-hand.

C) The books were sold here are second-hand.

  I CAN...

-  ☐ tell defining and non-defining clauses apart
-  ☐ reduce a clause: *the man standing there* · *the letter written by John*
-  ☐ join ideas for time, reason and sequence: *Feeling tired...* · *Having finished...*
-  ☐ find and fix a dangling participle
-  ☐ cut a wordy text down without losing any facts

 MY NEW WORDS

 MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Reduce one sentence from a message you wrote this week. Was the short version better, or was the full clause clearer? Why?

NEW WORDS — MEETINGS AND REPORTING

a meeting

the chair

the minutes

the agenda

a decision

to propose

to object to

in the end

it was agreed that...

the minutes = the written record of a meeting: who was there, what each person said or did, and what was decided

GRAMMAR BOX

A precise verb reports what the speaker was **doing**: offering, refusing, admitting... Learn each verb **with its pattern**.

① verb + to	agree, offer, promise, refuse, threaten	She refused to sign .
② verb + person + to	advise, ask, warn, remind, encourage, persuade, invite	He reminded us to lock the door.
③ verb + (that)	admit, explain, claim, deny, insist, complain	She admitted (that) she had forgotten .
④ verb + -ing	admit, deny, suggest, recommend, mention	He denied taking the key.
⑤ verb + preposition + -ing	apologize for, accuse sb of, insist on, blame sb for, congratulate sb on, warn sb against	He insisted on paying .

The meeting six

suggest	She suggested meeting on Friday. · She suggested (that) we meet on Friday.
insist	He insisted on paying . · She insisted (that) she had paid .
deny	He denied taking it. · He denied (that) he had taken it.
admit	She admitted forgetting . · She admitted (that) she had forgotten .
agree	He agreed to help . · They agreed (that) it was a good idea.
refuse	She refused to sign . (no <i>not</i> : <i>refuse</i> is already negative)

✗ She suggested **me to go**. · ✗ He apologized **to be** late. · ✗ She reminded **to call**. · ✗ I **am agree**.

✓ She suggested **going**. · ✓ He apologized **for being** late. · ✓ She reminded **him to call**. · ✓ I **agree**.

deny = say something is not true (the past) · **refuse** = say no to doing something (the future)

🔹 📌 EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO THE RESIDENTS' MEETING. COMPLETE THE MINUTES.

Write the **name** and the **reporting verb**. Choose from: *suggested · denied · admitted · refused · agreed · insisted on · reminded*

People: Ms. Park (the chair) · Mr. Diaz (the building manager) · Tom (apartment 2C) · Ms. Okafor (apartment 4A)

1. _____ making a schedule so each floor has its own laundry day.
2. _____ taking down the "Out of order" sign.
3. _____ leaving his clothes in the dryer all weekend.
4. _____ to buy a new washing machine until the owner approved it.
5. _____ to make the schedule and put it on the door.
6. _____ cleaning the laundry room on Saturday.
7. _____ everyone to take their clothes out on time.

🔹 📌 EXERCISE 2 – CHOOSE THE BEST VERB

Use: *offered · refused · admitted · warned · accused · apologized*

1. "I'll carry that for you." → He _____ to carry it.
2. "No, I absolutely won't sign." → She _____ to sign.
3. "OK, it was my mistake." → He _____ that it was his mistake.
4. "Careful, that step is slippery." → She _____ me about the slippery step.
5. "You took my stapler!" → He _____ her of taking his stapler.
6. "Sorry I shouted." → She _____ for shouting.

🔹 📌 EXERCISE 3 – PUT IT IN THE CORRECT PATTERN

Report each line with the verb in brackets.

1. (promise) "I'll call you back before noon." → She _____ me back before noon.
2. (deny) "I didn't take the money." → He _____ the money.
3. (advise) "You should walk more slowly." → The doctor _____ more slowly.
4. (insist on) "No, no, we'll pay the bill." → They _____ the bill.
5. (suggest) "Why don't we take a taxi?" → She _____ a taxi instead of the bus.
6. (congratulate sb on) "Well done on passing the exam!" → We _____ the exam.
7. (refuse) "I won't pay for the broken glass." → He _____ for the broken glass.
8. (agree) "OK, I'll work on Saturday." → She _____ on Saturday.

◆ 📖 ✎ EXERCISE 4 – FIX THE PATTERN ERROR

1. She suggested me to take the earlier train. → _____
2. He recommended me to visit the old town. → _____
3. They apologized to be late. → _____
4. He accused me to steal his idea. → _____
5. She admitted to break the vase. → _____
6. I am agree with the new schedule. → _____
7. He denied to work on Saturday. (He said, "I won't work on Saturday.") → _____

◆ ✎ EXERCISE 5 – REPORT THE MEETING WITH THE MEETING SIX

1. Lena: "Why don't we start the meeting at nine instead of eight?" (suggest) → _____
2. Omar: "No, I'm not going to change my day off." (refuse) → _____
3. Kate: "I didn't lose the keys! I gave them to Paul." (deny) → _____
4. Paul: "You're right. I forgot to give them back." (admit) → _____
5. Mia: "Fine, I'll order the new chairs." (agree) → _____
6. Sam: "No, really, I'll stay late and lock up. I insist." (insist on) → _____

◆ 📖 🗣️ DIALOGUE – A DIFFICULT MONDAY

Dana: I'm really sorry. I forgot to send the report yesterday.

Marco: That's the second time. You said you'd have it ready.

Dana: I know. I'll finish it tonight, I give you my word.

Marco: Why don't you set a reminder on your phone?

Dana: Good idea. And I'll email the client to explain. No, I insist, let me handle it.

Marco: Fine. But don't miss the Friday deadline, whatever happens.

✎ Report the conversation in six sentences, one precise verb per line. Start: *Dana apologized for...*

◆ 🗣️ SPEAKING – THE MEETING & THE MINUTES

🗣️ **The meeting:** your group gets a situation and role cards. Play your card, not yourself. Make your three moves naturally. The chair opens, keeps turns fair and closes with a decision.

 **The minutes:** no *said* or *told*. Use at least **six different** reporting verbs.

Meeting	_____ Date: _____	
Present		
Who?	Verb + pattern	What they did
Decision	It was agreed that...	

 Swap minutes with a partner. Tick every correct pattern. Circle any "suggested me to."

  SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

"Don't walk on the ice." Which correctly reports this warning?

- A) She warned walking on the ice.
- B) She warned us not to walk on the ice.
- C) She warned us to don't walk on the ice.

2

"Let's eat out tonight." Which report is correct?

- A) He suggested us to eat out that night.
- B) He suggested to eat out that night.
- C) He suggested eating out that night.

3

"I didn't break the printer!" Which report is correct?

- A) He denied breaking the printer.
- B) He denied to break the printer.
- C) He refused breaking the printer.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ report what someone was doing with one precise verb (offer, refuse, admit...)
- ◆ ☐ use the right pattern after each verb (*to* · *person* + *to* · *that* · *-ing* · *preposition* + *-ing*)
- ◆ ☐ use *suggest*, *insist*, *deny*, *admit*, *agree*, *refuse* correctly
- ◆ ☐ avoid "suggested me to" and "apologized to be"
- ◆ ☐ take part in a meeting and write clear minutes

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Report two moments from a real or invented conversation this week with two verbs from different patterns (for example, *refused to* and *apologized for*).

Fluency & Style

Join your ideas into arguments that are easy to follow. Put the spotlight exactly where you want it. Then bring everything from Modules 1–4 together: give a short talk, handle a challenge, and hold your own in a discussion. This is the halfway point of B2!

Lessons 4.1–4.3

Classes C10–C12

Level B2

Name: _____

ICONS

 Write ·  Listen ·  Say ·  Work with a partner ·  Read

In this module you'll argue, persuade and give opinions. You never have to share your real views. You can argue the side on your card, use a persona card, or take the "devil's advocate" role. Good speakers can argue any side. You can always say "Pass."

NEW WORDS — EVERYDAY TRADE-OFFS

 working from home: no commute	 but the daily isolating commute can feel	 time lost, but a clear lower cost of living in the country	 but few jobs, social media: stay in touch, but easy to get
---	--	--	--

a trade-off

an advantage / a drawback

to weigh up both sides

to pivot (to the other side)

a balanced conclusion

a linker / a connector

a clause (subject + verb)

GRAMMAR BOX

The key question: what comes after the linker? A clause, a noun / -ing form, or a new sentence?

Contrast + clause	although · though · even though · whereas · while	Although it was raining, we went out. · He likes tea, whereas she prefers coffee.
Contrast + noun / -ing	despite · in spite of (+ the fact that + clause)	Despite the rain, we went out. · In spite of being tired, she finished.
Contrast: new sentence	However, · Nevertheless, · On the other hand,	It was expensive. However , we bought it.
Cause + clause	because · since · as	We stayed in because it was raining. · Since you're here, let's start.
Cause + noun	because of · due to · owing to (more formal)	The match was canceled due to bad weather.
Result	so + clause · so + adj / adv + that · such + (a / an) + noun + that	It was so cold that the lake froze. · It was such a good movie that I watched it twice.
Result: new sentence	Therefore, · Consequently, · As a result,	Sales fell. Therefore , the store closed.
Purpose	so as to · in order to + base verb	She left early in order to catch the train.

 **Punctuation:** It was late. **However**, we stayed. · It was late; **however**, we stayed. · **Although** it was late, we stayed.

 **Register:** *so, but, that's why* in a chat · *therefore, consequently, nevertheless, whereas* in a talk or in writing.

 EXERCISE 1 – CITY OR COUNTRYSIDE?

a) Listen to the mini-talk. Does the speaker prefer the city or the countryside?

b) Listen again. Write the missing linker. Then write **C** (contrast), **Ca** (cause) or **R** (result).

A lot of people love the city (1) _____ there's always something to do, and (2) _____ public transportation is everywhere, you don't really need a car. (3) _____, city life has a price. Rents are (4) _____ high that many young people share an apartment well into their thirties. In the countryside, life is slower and cheaper, (5) _____ in the city everything moves fast. (6) _____ the lower cost of living, people often leave rural areas (7) _____ the lack of jobs. My cousin moved back to her village last year. It was (8) _____ a peaceful place that she started sleeping better within a week. (9) _____ she earns less, she says she's happier. (10) _____, I'd say the right choice depends on the stage of life you're in.

C / Ca / R: 1 _____ · 2 _____ · 3 _____ · 4 _____ · 5 _____ · 6 _____ · 7 _____ · 8 _____ · 9 _____ · 10 _____

 EXERCISE 2 – CIRCLE THE LINKER THAT FITS THE GRAMMAR

1. (Although / Despite) the long wait, the customers stayed calm.
2. (Although / Despite) the wait was long, the customers stayed calm.
3. The train was delayed (because / because of) a signal problem.
4. The train was delayed (because / because of) the signals weren't working.
5. The rent is lower here. (However / Although), the commute is much longer.
6. My brother saves every dollar, (whereas / despite) I spend mine on travel.
7. The event was postponed (due to / since) the storm.
8. She took an evening class (so as to / so that to) improve her writing.

 EXERCISE 3 – JOIN THE IDEAS WITH THE LINKER IN BRACKETS

Change the grammar so that the linker fits. Example: It was cold. We went for a walk. (despite) → **Despite the cold, we went for a walk.**

1. The office is modern. Nobody likes working there. (although) → _____
2. He was nervous. He gave an excellent presentation. (in spite of) → _____
3. The flight was canceled. There was a technical fault. (due to) → _____

4. Online shopping is quick. Shopping in person is more social. (whereas) → _____
5. The bakery raised its prices. It lost customers. (consequently) → _____
6. It was raining. The concert went ahead. (despite the fact that) → _____

◆ ✎ EXERCISE 4 – SO OR SUCH (A / AN)?

1. The meeting was _____ long that half of us forgot the first point.
2. It was _____ useful workshop that I signed up for another one.
3. Our neighbors are _____ generous people that they fed the whole street.
4. He explained it _____ clearly that everyone understood the first time.
5. It was _____ awful traffic jam that we missed the start of the wedding.

◆ 📖 EXERCISE 5 – FIND AND FIX THE MISTAKE

1. Despite it was expensive, we booked the hotel. → _____
2. The road was closed because of there was an accident. → _____
3. However the job was hard, she loved it. → _____
4. Although the prices are low, but the quality is poor. → _____
5. It was so a good book that I read it in one night. → _____

◆ 📖 🗣️ DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

Ana: You moved to the countryside, right? Do you miss the city?

Jon: A bit. It's much quieter here, **whereas** the city never sleeps.

Ana: But you're happy?

Jon: Very. **Despite** the longer drive to work, life feels calmer. And the rent is **so** cheap **that** we could afford a garden.

Ana: Nice. I couldn't do it, **though**. I'd get bored.

Jon: Fair enough. **Since** you love going out at night, you'd probably hate it. **So** you should stay where you are!

◆ 🗣️ SPEAKING – THE ARGUMENT BUILDER

🗣️ **Round 1:** argue the side on your cards (FOR or AGAINST). Put a linker card down every time you use it with the right grammar after it.

🗣️ **Round 2:** give a **balanced two-minute mini-talk** on a new topic. Plan it here (notes, not full sentences).

My topic

Hook (1 sentence)	
Side 1 + a reason (because / since / due to)	
Pivot (However, / Although... / Despite...)	
Side 2 + a result (so... that / such... that / therefore)	
Balanced conclusion	

Let's weigh up...

On the one hand, ... On the other hand, ...

Although this is true, ...

As a result, ...

All in all, I'd say it depends on...

◆  SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which sentence is correct?

A) Despite the train was delayed, we caught it.

B) Despite the delay, we caught the train.

C) Although the delay, we caught the train.

2

"It was ___ interesting book ___ I finished it in one night."

A) so ... that

B) such an ... so

C) such an ... that

3

Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

A) The shop was losing money; therefore, it closed.

B) The shop was losing money, therefore it closed.

C) The shop was losing money therefore, it closed.

◆  I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ use **although / even though** + a clause and **despite / in spite of** + a noun or -ing
- ◆ ☐ use **because** + a clause and **because of / due to** + a noun
- ◆ ☐ choose **so... that** or **such... that**
- ◆ ☐ start a new sentence with **However, / Therefore,** and punctuate it correctly
- ◆ ☐ give a balanced two-minute talk that weighs up both sides

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (4-6 SENTENCES)

Is social media a blessing or a curse? Give a balanced view (real or invented). Use one contrast, one cause and one result linker. Underline each one and write what came after it: clause, noun, or new sentence.

4.2 Adding Emphasis — Cleft Sentences & Inversion

Class C11

NEW PHRASES — PUTTING THE SPOTLIGHT ON IT

It was ... who ...

It was ... that ...

What I really want is ...

What he did was ...

The thing that worries me is ...

The reason I called is ...

All I want is ...

Not only ... but also ...

Never have I ...

No sooner ... than ...

to emphasize

to spotlight

to correct a wrong idea

to build up to a point

dramatic

formal

theatrical (too much!)

GRAMMAR BOX

<i>It</i>-cleft	It + be + spotlight + who / that + the rest	It was Maria who booked the hotel (not me). · It was on Monday that I called.
<i>What</i>-cleft	What + clause + be + key idea (last!)	What I need is a vacation . · What annoys me is the noise .
An action	What + subject + did + was (to) + verb	What he did was (to) ignore me.
Other frames	The thing (that)... is · The reason (why)... is · The place where... is · All (that)... is	The reason I called is to say thank you. · All I want is a quiet weekend.

Negative inversion: a negative word at the start + **question word order** (auxiliary + subject). It's formal and dramatic: use it like a spice.

Never	I have never seen such a mess. → Never have I seen such a mess.
Not only... but also	Not only did she win, but she also broke the record.
No sooner... than	No sooner had we left than it started to rain.
Hardly / Scarcely... when	Hardly had I sat down when the phone rang.
Rarely / Seldom	Rarely does she complain. (no auxiliary? add do / does / did)
Little · Only then	Little did they know what was coming. · Only then did I understand.

EXERCISE 1 — THE TEAM LUNCH

Listen to two coworkers. Answer the questions.

1. Who really organized the lunch? _____

2. When did the speaker book the table? _____
3. What impressed the speaker most? _____
4. What surprised the speaker? _____
5. Write the three sentences with negative inversion that you hear.

◆ ✎ EXERCISE 2 – MAKE AN *IT* -CLEFT

Put the spotlight on the part in **bold**.

1. **My neighbor** fixed my bike. → _____
2. We first met **in Chicago**. → _____
3. The storm damaged **the roof**. → _____
4. They moved **in 2019**. → _____
5. **The manager's email** caused all the confusion. → _____

◆ ✎ EXERCISE 3 – BUILD UP TO THE KEY IDEA

Rewrite with the frame in brackets.

1. I admire her honesty. (What...) → _____
2. The traffic frustrates me. (What...) → _____
3. He simply apologized. (What he did...) → _____
4. The cost worries me. (The thing that...) → _____
5. I called to say thank you. (The reason...) → _____

◆ ✎ EXERCISE 4 – MAKE IT DRAMATIC

Start with the word(s) given. Use question word order.

1. I have never tasted such good coffee. → Never _____
2. She didn't just call; she also came in person. → Not only _____
3. We had just sat down when the alarm went off. → No sooner _____
4. He rarely asks for help. → Rarely _____
5. They realized the danger only later. → Only later _____

◆ 📖 EXERCISE 5 – FIND AND FIX THE MISTAKE

1. Never I have worked on such a busy project. → _____

2. No sooner had we arrived when it started to rain. → _____
3. What I need it is a long rest. → _____
4. Rarely she complains about her job. → _____
5. It is Tomás who organized the party last Friday. → _____

◆ 📖 🗣️ DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

Kai: So you finally finished the marketing plan? Well done.

Lena: Actually, **it was Priya who** finished it. I only wrote the introduction.

Kai: Oh! Still, it looks great. What's the next step?

Lena: Honestly? **What we really need is** more time. **Not only did** the deadline move, but we **also** lost two people.

Kai: That's rough.

Lena: **Never have** I worked on a project with so many changes. But **the reason I'm still optimistic is** the team. Everyone's pulling together.

◆ 🗣️ SPEAKING – MAKE IT EMPHATIC

🗣️ **Set the Record Straight:** your partner has the facts wrong. Correct them: "Actually, **it was Nadia who** organized it. **What Sam did was** bring the music."

🗣️ **My emphatic opinion (60–90 seconds).** Choose a prompt card or an everyday topic. Plan it here.

My topic	
Open with a frame (The thing that... / The reason...)	
Correct a common view (People think... but it's... that...)	
Build up (What really matters is...)	
Strong close (optional: Never have I... / Not only...)	

◆ 🗣️ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Someone thinks you broke the vase, but it was the cat. Which sentence corrects them best?

A) What broke the vase is the cat.

B) The cat broke the vase.

C) It was the cat that broke the vase.

2

Which sentence has the correct word order?

A) Never I have felt so proud.

B) Never have I felt so proud.

C) No sooner I felt proud when it faded.

3

Which *what*-cleft is correct?

A) What I need is a quiet weekend.

B) What I need it is a quiet weekend.

C) What I need a quiet weekend is.

◆ ☒ I CAN...

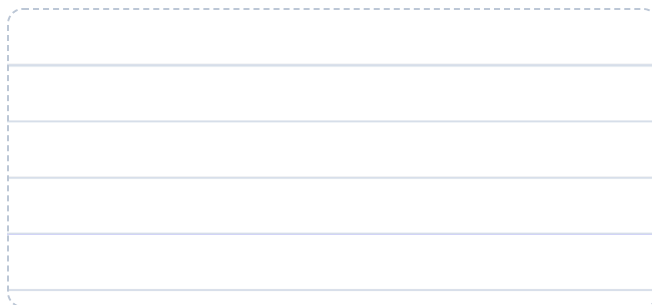
- ◆ ☐ correct a wrong idea with an *it*-cleft: It was... who / that...
- ◆ ☐ build up to my key point with a *what*-cleft or another frame
- ◆ ☐ use negative inversion with question word order (Never have I... / Not only did...)
- ◆ ☐ put the stress on the part I want to spotlight
- ◆ ☐ give a short emphatic opinion and choose when inversion is too much

◆  MY NEW WORDS

◆  MY JOURNAL (4 VERSIONS)

Write one plain sentence about your week (true or invented), e.g. "My friend recommended a great podcast on Tuesday." Rewrite it four ways: an *it*-cleft on the person, an *it*-cleft on the time, a *what*-cleft,

and an inversion. Which one feels the most powerful?
Why?

A dashed rectangular box with four horizontal lines inside, intended for a student to write their answer to the question above.

NEW PHRASES — PRESENTING AND DISCUSSING

 Signposting a talk

I'd like to talk about...

I'd like to argue that...

I'll cover three points...

Let me start by...

Firstly, / To begin with,

Moving on to...

Turning now to...

This brings me to...

Finally,

To sum up, / In conclusion,

 Building a case

There are several reasons for this.

One key advantage is...

A further point is that...

The evidence suggests...

It could be argued that...

The main drawback is...

 Concede, then counter · Persuade · Hedge

That's a fair point, but...

I take your point; however,...

You're right to an extent, though...

Granted, but we shouldn't forget that...

The fact is,...

What we can't ignore is...

The bottom line is...

arguably

to some extent

It seems to me that...

EXERCISE 1 — WHAT IS THE PHRASE DOING?

Write **S** (signpost), **C** (concede, then counter), **P** (persuade) or **H** (hedge).

1. _____ "Moving on to the cost..."
2. _____ "I take your point; however, it would take years."
3. _____ "The bottom line is, we can't afford it."
4. _____ "Arguably, it's the most important factor."
5. _____ "To sum up, the benefits outweigh the risks."
6. _____ "Granted, but we shouldn't forget the staff."
7. _____ "It seems to me that the plan is too ambitious."
8. _____ "What we can't ignore is how tired people are."

EXERCISE 2 — SHOULD WE TRY A FOUR-DAY WEEK?

- a) Listen to the presentation. Number the signposts in the order you hear them (1–6).

_____ Moving on to... _____ To sum up... _____ I'd like to talk about... _____ Finally... _____ I'll cover three points... _____ Let me start with...

b) Listen again. Tick (✓) the B2 structures you hear.

☐ an impersonal passive (It is... believed that...) ☐ a *what*-cleft ☐ a participle clause (Having...) ☐ a mixed conditional ☐ negative inversion ☐ *used to* ☐ *must have* + past participle

c) What objection does Dana raise? How does the speaker answer it?

EXERCISE 3 – REWRITE FOR RANGE

Rewrite each sentence with the B2 structure in brackets.

1. People think online shopping has changed our towns forever. (impersonal passive) → _____

2. We didn't plan ahead, so we have this problem now. (mixed conditional) → _____

3. The cost is the thing that concerns me most. (*what*-cleft) → _____

4. I looked at the data, and then I reached my conclusion. (participle clause) → _____

5. The plan saves money. It also saves time. (Not only...) → _____

EXERCISE 4 – CORRECT THE ERROR

1. Not only it saves money, but it also saves time. → _____

2. It could be argue that we acted too late. → _____

3. Despite it is popular, the app has many problems. → _____

4. We discussed about the plan for an hour. → _____

5. If we would have started earlier, we would have finished. → _____

EXERCISE 5 – CONCEDE, THEN COUNTER

Answer each challenge. First accept part of it, then disagree with a reason.

1. "Self-checkout machines are faster for everyone." → _____

2. "Children don't need homework at all." → _____

3. "Nobody will use cash in ten years." → _____

DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

Rosa: The trouble with cashless shops is that they shut out people who don't have a bank card.

Sam: **That's a fair point.** Not everyone has one, I won't pretend otherwise. **However,** the evidence suggests that most customers prefer to pay by card, so shops save time and money.

Rosa: **Granted, but we shouldn't forget** older customers. My grandmother has always paid in cash.

Sam: **I take your point;** that's exactly why it matters how it's done. **Surely you'd agree that** the answer is to help people switch, not to ban cards altogether?

Rosa: **Up to a point. What we can't ignore is** that some people will always need cash.

◆ PROJECT PART A – MY TWO-MINUTE TALK

Choose a topic card or your own everyday topic. Write **notes**, not a script. You can argue any side.

① Open: I'd like to talk about / argue that...	
② Preview: I'll cover... points	
③ Point 1: claim + reason + example	
Point 2: claim + reason + example	
(Point 3)	
④ Close: To sum up...	
Two objections I expect + my answer (concede → counter)	

 **My B2 toolkit:** I will use at least one structure from Module 1 ☐ · Module 2 ☐ · Module 3 ☐ · and a linker or emphasis structure from Module 4 ☐

◆ PROJECT PART B – THE GROUP DISCUSSION

You get a side card: **For**, **Against**, **Devil's advocate** or **Chair**. Argue your card, not your personal opinion.

Our question	
My side / role	
My 2 points	
A concession I'm ready to make	

Building on what ___ said, ...

I see where you're coming from, yet...

___, where do you stand on this?

So, to bring it all together...

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Your partner makes a point that is partly true, but you still disagree. What's the best reply?

A) "No, that's completely wrong."

B) "That's a fair point; however, the bigger picture tells a different story."

C) "Yes, you're totally right. I have nothing to add."

2

Which sentence uses the B2 grammar correctly?

A) "Not only it reduces costs, but it also improves safety."

B) "It is believe that the plan will work."

C) "Not only does it reduce costs, but it also improves safety."

3

You've finished your first point and want to start the second. You say:

A) "Moving on to my second point, ..."

B) "To sum up, ..."

C) "I'd like to talk about..."

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ open, preview, move between points and close a talk with signposts
- ◆ ☐ support each point with a reason and an example or evidence
- ◆ ☐ answer a challenge by conceding, then countering
- ◆ ☐ hedge a claim I can't fully prove (arguably, to some extent)
- ◆ ☐ take part in a discussion from an assigned side and respond to the last speaker
- ◆ ☐ use structures from Modules 1–4 in a longer talk

◆  MY NEW WORDS

◆  MY JOURNAL (ONE PARAGRAPH + 2 SENTENCES)

Write one paragraph of argued English on any everyday topic. Use three different B2 structures and

underline them. Then write two sentences to the learner you were on the first day of this course: what can you do now?

MODULE 4 — WELL DONE! YOU'RE HALFWAY THROUGH B2 🎉

You can link ideas into a clear argument, put the spotlight where you want it, give a signposted talk, and concede and counter in a discussion. Look at your three "I can..." lists. Is a box empty? Tell your teacher. Next class is a friendly check of Modules 1–4. Practice at home with the online lessons 4.1, 4.2 and 4.3 and the 🎧 buttons.

Precision Grammar

Small choices that make your English exact. Place an action precisely on a future timeline: still happening, or already done? Say precisely who did the work: you, or someone you paid? And say precisely how much of a group you mean, with a verb that agrees.

Lessons 5.1–5.3

Classes C14–C16

Level B2

Name: _____

ICONS

 Write •  Listen •  Say •  Work with a partner •  Read

What you share about your own life is always **your** choice. In this module you can talk about a project or a character from a card, invent the details, or keep your answers anonymous. All of these are good. You can always say "Pass."

MY GOAL AFTER PROGRESS TEST 1

I did well in _____.

I want to practice _____.

I can do it! Every week I will _____.

NEW WORDS — PLANS, DEADLINES AND MILESTONES



This time
tomorrow,
I'll
be
flying



a deadline
a



the launch
opening
day



ahead
of / on / behind
schedule

Useful frames:

This time next year...

By then, we'll have...

By the time you get here...

In a few years' time...

At 10 a.m. tomorrow, I'll be...

Will you be joining us?

They'll have left by now.

GRAMMAR BOX

Choose a **reference point** in the future first. Then ask: is the action **still happening** then, or **already finished**?

	Future continuous: in progress	Future perfect: already done
Form	will be + -ing	will have + past participle
At 8 p.m.	We'll be eating dinner. (still at the table)	We'll have eaten dinner. (plates cleared)
This time next year	I'll be studying in Berlin.	I'll have graduated .
Negative / question	We won't be using the room. · Will you be staying long?	He won't have arrived by six. · Will you have eaten ?
Typical markers	this time tomorrow / next week · at + clock time	by · by then · by the time · in + period

Polite inquiries	Will you use the car tonight? → Will you be using the car tonight? (softer: it asks about your plans, not for a decision)
by the time	By the time you arrive (present!), we'll have left . ❌ By the time you will arrive...
by vs until	I'll have finished by six. (= no later than six) · I'll be working until six. (= all the time up to six) ❌ I'll have finished until six.

EXERCISE 1 — LISTEN TO LENA'S PROJECT UPDATE. COMPLETE THE SENTENCES.

Lena manages the renovation of the Riverside Community Center. Your teacher reads her voicemail to the volunteers. Write the verb forms you hear.

1. By the end of this month, the builders _____ the new roof.
2. In April, they _____ on the kitchen.
3. By the time the summer program _____ in June,
4. ... they _____ all the classrooms,
5. ... and the new computers _____.
6. At ten on opening day, the mayor _____ the ribbon.
7. From eleven, volunteers _____ free lunch.
8. Lena asks: " _____ to the volunteer meeting on Thursday?"

 EXERCISE 2 – IN PROGRESS OR ALREADY DONE? WRITE THE FUTURE CONTINUOUS OR THE FUTURE PERFECT.

1. Please don't call the office between two and four. I _____ (interview) job candidates.
2. By the time the guests arrive, the caterers _____ (set up) all the tables.
3. This time next month, the new bus line _____ (run) through our neighborhood.
4. In three weeks, the team _____ (test) the app with 200 users, so we can launch in May.
5. At 7:30 tomorrow morning, trucks _____ (unload) outside the store, so park on the side street.
6. By 2030, the city _____ (plant) 10,000 new trees.

 EXERCISE 3 – BY, UNTIL OR BY THE TIME? COMPLETE THE SENTENCES.

1. The report has to be on my desk _____ Friday.
2. The builders will be working on the kitchen _____ the end of April.
3. _____ the guests _____ (arrive), we'll have finished cooking.
4. I'll have answered all the emails _____ lunchtime.
5. The pharmacy will be open _____ 10 p.m. tonight.
6. _____ you _____ (get) this message, I'll have left for the airport.

 EXERCISE 4 – MAKE IT POLITE. REWRITE EACH QUESTION WITH THE FUTURE CONTINUOUS.

Example: (a hotel) "Will you pay by card?" → **Will you be paying by card?**

1. (a colleague) "Are you going to use the projector this afternoon?" → _____

2. (a restaurant) "How many people will come?" → _____
3. (an airline) "Will you check any bags?" → _____
4. (a manager) "Do you plan to take vacation in August?" → _____
5. (a receptionist) "How long will you stay?" → _____

 Say them to a partner with a friendly rise at the end: "Will you be **paying by card**? ↗"

 EXERCISE 5 – FIND THE MISTAKE. WRITE THE CORRECT SENTENCE.

1. By the time you will get here, we'll have eaten. → _____
2. I'll have finished the report until six. → _____
3. By 2030, she will finished her degree. → _____
4. Don't call at 8 — we'll have watched the game. (The game starts at 7 and ends at 9.) → _____
5. This time next week, I'll be lie on a beach. → _____

 DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

Joe: So, Nina, where do you see yourself this time next year?

Nina: Well, I'll have finished my training by then, so I'll probably be working at the new clinic downtown.

Joe: Nice. And by the time you start, will you have moved into the city?

Nina: I hope so. By September we'll have signed the lease, and by winter we'll be settling into the new place.

Joe: It sounds like this time next year you'll be looking back on a huge year — and you'll have earned the rest.

 Underline the future continuous in one color and the future perfect in another. What is the reference point in each sentence? Write two: _____

 SPEAKING – PROJECT TIMELINE

Choose a **project card** (a community center, a food co-op, a bike-share launch...) or a **character card**. In your group, plan the timeline in key words. Then present it to another group, who ask you questions: "Will you be hiring local people?" · "Will you have finished the parking lot by opening day?"

When?	What will be happening? (will be + -ing)	What will already be done? (will have + p.p.)
next month		

by the time...		
this time next year		
in five years' time		

Our project / character: _____

◆  SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

"Don't call at 8 — we ____ dinner then." Which form fits an action in progress at 8?

A) will be having

B) will have had

C) will have

2

Which sentence is correct?

A) By the time you arrive, I'll have cooked dinner.

B) By the time you will arrive, I'll have cooked dinner.

C) I'll have cooked dinner until you arrive.

3

A hotel receptionist wants to ask about your plans in a polite, neutral way. What does she say?

A) Will you pay by card?

B) Will you be paying by card?

C) Will you have paid by card?

◆  I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ say what will be happening at a future moment: This time tomorrow, I'll be flying.
- ◆ ☐ say what will be finished by a future point: By Friday, we'll have finished.
- ◆ ☐ use **by**, **by then** and **by the time** + present, and not confuse **by** with **until**

- ◆ ☐ ask polite, neutral questions: Will you be using the car tonight?
- ◆ ☐ present a project timeline and answer questions about it

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (4 SENTENCES)

Choose a project (at work, in your community, or from a card) or a character. Write two future continuous and two future perfect sentences about it. Underline the reference point in each. Or: your week — this time tomorrow / by Sunday night.

NEW WORDS — EVERYDAY SERVICES

 get the car serviced / the oil	 have the sink fixed / unclogged	 have a window replaced	 get a spare key made / copied
 have your pants shortened /	 get a jacket dry-cleaned	 have your shoes repaired	 get the screen replaced
 have your passport photo taken	 get your hair cut · get a haircut	 get flyers / printed copies	

Places: the auto shop · the hair salon / barber shop · the print & copy shop · the dry cleaner's · the alterations shop · the phone repair kiosk · the key counter at the hardware store · the building manager

GRAMMAR BOX

I cut my hair. = I did it myself. · **I had my hair cut.** = someone did it for me (I arranged it).

Recipe	have / get + object + past participle
Present	I have my car serviced every year.
Present continuous	She's having her hair cut right now.
Past	We had the house painted last month.
Present perfect	I've just had my eyes tested.
Future	They'll have the roof repaired soon. · I'm going to have the kitchen redone.
Modals	You should get your teeth checked. · We should have had it fixed sooner.

Only **have / get** changes. The order is always **have → thing → done**. ❌ I had repaired my car. (= past perfect: I did it myself, earlier.)

have or get?	Same meaning. have = a little more neutral / formal · get = informal, very common in speech; can mean "finally managed": <i>I finally got the heater fixed.</i>
---------------------	---

Misfortune	Same form, but something bad happened to you: <i>She had her bag stolen. They had their flight canceled.</i>
get + person + to	persuade: <i>I got my landlord to fix the window.</i>
have + person + verb	arrange (no to): <i>I'll have the porter bring your bags up.</i>
have + person + -ing	cause something ongoing: <i>She soon had everyone laughing.</i>

🔹 🗣️ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO MARCO'S VOICEMAIL. COMPLETE THE SENTENCES.

Marco is telling his partner about his busy Saturday morning.

1. Marco is having the car _____.
2. The auto shop is also replacing the front _____.
3. He got the flyers for the block party _____.
4. He had a spare key _____ for his partner's mom.
5. He's going to get his hair _____ next week.
6. He finally got the building manager _____ the kitchen sink.
7. The manager is having someone _____ at the bathroom window too.
8. Who washed the dog? _____

🔹 ✎ EXERCISE 2 – REWRITE WITH THE CAUSATIVE. KEEP THE TENSE. USE HAVE UNLESS IT SAYS GET .

Example: A mechanic serviced my car yesterday. → I **had my car serviced** yesterday.

1. A mechanic changes the oil in my car every six months. → I _____ every six months.
2. A technician is replacing my phone screen right now. → I _____ right now.
3. The print shop printed our wedding invitations. (get) → We _____.
4. A plumber has just fixed the leak under our sink. → We _____.
5. A tailor will shorten my new pants. → I _____.
6. A painter is going to paint our living room. → We _____.
7. Someone scratched her car in the parking lot. (misfortune) → She _____.

🔹 ✎ EXERCISE 3 – MYSELF OR A PROFESSIONAL? WRITE THE PLAIN VERB OR THE CAUSATIVE.

1. I don't trust salons, so I _____ (cut) my own bangs.

2. Our dishwasher was leaking, so we _____ (repair — have) last week.
3. My brother is great with cars. He always _____ (change) his own oil.
4. You should _____ (check — get / your eyes) if the headaches keep coming back.
5. We _____ (not / paint) the house ourselves. We hired a company and _____ (paint — have).
6. She _____ (fix) the printer herself by watching a video.

 EXERCISE 4 — WHAT DOES IT MEAN? WRITE A, B OR C.

a = a service they arranged · **b** = something bad that happened to them · **c** = past perfect: they did it themselves, earlier

1. He had his wallet stolen. _____
2. He had stolen a wallet. _____
3. He had his watch repaired. _____
4. They got their flight canceled. _____
5. She had her nails done for the wedding. _____
6. She had done her nails before the wedding. _____

 EXERCISE 5 — GET SOMEONE TO / HAVE SOMEONE DO. WRITE THE VERB IN THE RIGHT FORM.

1. I finally got my landlord _____ (replace) the broken window.
2. The hotel will have a porter _____ (bring) your bags up.
3. Can you get the electrician _____ (call) me back?
4. The manager had her assistant _____ (reschedule) the meeting.
5. The comedian had everyone _____ (laugh) within a minute.
6. I'll have the front desk _____ (send) you a copy.

 DIALOGUE — READ WITH A PARTNER

A: Your car looks brand new! Did you clean it yourself?

B: No way. I had it detailed at that new place. And I finally got the dent fixed too.

A: Nice. I really need to get mine serviced. The warning light's been on for weeks.

B: You should have it checked soon. My neighbor ignored hers and ended up having the whole engine rebuilt.

A: Ouch. OK, I'll make an appointment. While I'm at it, I might have the tires replaced as well.

 Underline every causative. Which one uses **get** to mean "finally managed"?

 SPEAKING – ERRAND WEEK AND SERVICES & ERRANDS

 **Errand Week:** A has Sam's to-do list; B has his receipts and texts. Find out what he did himself, what he had done, what went wrong, and what he still needs to get done.

 **Services & Errands:** you are the customer or the service provider (auto shop, building manager, hair salon, print shop...). Customer: arrange two things, ask when they'll be ready ("Will you have finished by Friday?"), and ask one polite question ("Will you be calling me?").

 **My services** (real, a character, or invented):

I had done recently	I have done regularly	I'm going to have done soon
I had my phone screen replaced.		

One thing I do **myself**: _____

 SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A hairdresser cut your hair yesterday. Which sentence is correct?

A) I had my hair cut yesterday.

B) I had cut my hair yesterday.

C) I had cut yesterday my hair.

2

"She ___ on the train." Someone stole her bag; she didn't arrange it. Which fits?

A) had her bag stolen

B) had stolen her bag

C) stole her bag

3

Ana's brother didn't want to help her move, but she persuaded him. Which sentence says this?

A) Ana had her brother helped.

B) Ana got her brother to help.

C) Ana got her brother help.

◆  I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ say what I did myself and what I had done: I fixed it. / I had it fixed.
- ◆ ☐ use the causative in any tense and after *should*, with the thing before the participle
- ◆ ☐ choose **have** or **get**, and understand the "misfortune" meaning
- ◆ ☐ use **get** someone **to** do and **have** someone do
- ◆ ☐ arrange a service at a counter or on the phone

◆  MY NEW WORDS

◆  MY JOURNAL (4-5 SENTENCES)

Services in a week (yours, a character's, or invented): one thing had done recently, one done regularly, one to have done soon, and one thing done yourself. Then one light "misfortune" sentence (invented is fine).

NEW WORDS — TALKING ABOUT GROUPS AND DATA

100%	all of us · the whole class · every one of us · each of us
↓	almost all of us · the (vast) majority of us · most of us
about 50%	about half of us · just over / just under half of us
↓	some of us · a few of us · only a handful of us · a minority of us
0%	none of us · not one of us · not a single person
2 people / things	both (2 of 2) · either (1 of 2, any one) · neither (0 of 2)

We asked every person in the class...

a survey

a tally

the results show...

...preferred not to say

Surprisingly,...

GRAMMAR BOX

all / whole	all (+ the) + plural or uncountable · the / my + whole + singular · all day (no <i>the</i>)	all the books · all the information · the whole book · It rained all day / the whole day. ✗ all the day
every / each	+ singular noun + singular verb · every = the group as a whole · each = one by one (often two)	Every room has a view. · Each student gets a report. · a bag in each hand · almost every day ✗ every people
both	two together · plural verb · both ... and ...	Both restaurants are excellent.
neither / either	0 of 2 / 1 of 2 · singular verb · neither ... nor ... · either ... or ...	Neither option is cheap. · Either day works for me. · Neither of them is perfect.
+ of	before the / my / this / them / us	most of the people here · all of my friends · none of us · both of them
no of	general statements, bare nouns	Most people love music. · All children need sleep. ✗ most of people
none of	+ uncountable → singular · + plural → singular (formal) or plural (everyday)	None of the water was clean. · None of the students was / were late.

No **the**? Then no **of**. · **people** is already plural, so never *every people*. · **both / neither / either** = only two.

◆ ✎ EXERCISE 1 – CIRCLE THE CORRECT WORD.

1. I spent (all the / the whole) morning on the phone with the bank.
2. (Every / All) employee gets a free lunch on Fridays.
3. She wore a different earring in (each / every) ear.
4. (All / Every) the documents are on the shared drive.
5. (Most / Most of) people in my building work nights.
6. I asked two mechanics, but (neither / none) of them could fix it.
7. We invited five neighbors, but (neither / none) of them could come.
8. I go to the gym almost (every / each) day.

◆ ✎ EXERCISE 2 – EACH SENTENCE HAS ONE MISTAKE. WRITE THE CORRECT SENTENCE.

1. Every people in the office has a key card. → _____
2. Each of the apartments have a balcony. → _____
3. Neither of the buses go downtown. (formal) → _____
4. Most of students finished early. → _____
5. Both of the option is fine with me. → _____
6. It snowed all the week. → _____

◆ 📖 ✎ EXERCISE 3 – TWO APARTMENTS. COMPLETE WITH BOTH, NEITHER, EITHER (... NOR).

	Oak Street	Elm Avenue
Rent	\$1,400 a month	\$1,400 a month
Bedrooms	2	1
Near a bus stop	✓	✓
Parking	✗	✗
Pets allowed	✗	✗
Available	June 1	June 1

1. _____ apartments cost \$1,400 a month.
2. _____ apartment has parking.
3. _____ of them allows pets.
4. _____ apartments are near a bus stop, so _____ one would work for my commute.
5. They are _____ available on June 1.

6. _____ the Oak Street apartment _____ the Elm Avenue one allows pets.

 EXERCISE 4 – OF OR NO OF? WRITE OF OR x.

1. Most _____ people like weekends.
2. Most _____ the people in this class take the bus.
3. None _____ us had heard of the app.
4. All _____ children need sleep.
5. Some _____ my coworkers work from home on Fridays.
6. I've read all _____ them.

 EXERCISE 5 – LISTEN TO THE STAFF SURVEY RESULTS. COMPLETE THE REPORT.

The manager of Green Valley Market reports the results of a staff survey.

1. _____ of the staff answered the survey.
2. _____ of them want the new schedule to start in March.
3. _____ department sent in at least one suggestion.
4. _____ of the staff want the break room moved.
5. _____ parking option was popular.
6. _____ team leader has agreed to try the new app for a _____ month.
7. _____ of the new managers will be in touch next week.

 DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

- A: So, the apartment in the city or the house by the coast — which are you leaning toward?
- B: Honestly, both places have their charms, but neither option is cheap.
- A: True. Either choice means a longer commute, though.
- B: Exactly. Neither of them is perfect — but both of us agree we need more space.
- A: Then let's visit each one again and decide.

 Circle every determiner. Which verbs are singular? Why? _____

 SPEAKING – CLASS SURVEY & REPORT

With a partner, ask **everyone** in the class your survey question. Use tally marks, no names. "Pass" is an answer too. Then write your report and read it to the class.

Our question: _____

Answer	Tally	Total
--------	-------	-------

Pass		

 **Our report** (4–5 sentences): We asked every person in the class... · Most of us... / None of us... · Each of...
· Both of us / Neither of us (the two of us in our pair)...

 SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which sentence is correct?

A) Every student has a locker.

B) Every people have a locker.

C) Every student have a locker.

2

In careful, formal English, which is correct?

A) Neither of the plans is ready.

B) Neither the plans are ready.

C) Both of the plans is ready.

3

Which sentence is correct?

A) It rained all the day.

B) Most of people here walk to work.

C) Each of the rooms has a window.

  I CAN...

 ☐ choose **all** or **whole**: all the books · the whole book · all day

- ◆ ☐ use **every** and **each** with a singular noun and a singular verb
- ◆ ☐ use **both**, **neither** and **either** for two things, with the right verb
- ◆ ☐ use **of** only before the / my / them: most people · most of the people here · most of us
- ◆ ☐ report survey results with a range of quantifiers

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (6 SENTENCES)

Compare two groups you know (two teams, two stores, two apps, two workplaces, two neighborhoods). Use every or each once, both / neither / either once, and most of / none of / all of once. Underline every verb and check that it agrees.

◆ MODULE 5 – LOOK BACK AT MY GOAL

My goal after Progress Test 1 was: _____

Did I practice? ☐ Yes ☐ A little ☐ Not yet

Next, I will _____.

Words & Questions

Three kinds of precision. Build the exact **form** of a word (*decide* → *decision* → *decisive* → *decisively*). Say exactly **how big** a difference is (*far cheaper, only slightly heavier, nowhere near as good*). And ask questions in the right **shape** and tone for the moment (*Could you tell me where the station is? Isn't it beautiful?*).

Lessons 6.1–6.3

Classes C17–C19

Level B2

Name: _____

ICONS

 Write ·  Listen ·  Say ·  Work with a partner ·  Read

When a task is about your life, it's **your** choice what to share. You can talk about your real life, **or** use a new identity card, **or** invent something. All are equally good. In discussions you can always argue an **assigned side**, and you can always say "Pass."

NEW WORDS — TALKING ABOUT WORDS

(root):
the
base core word · *success*

prefix : a *un-, re-*
start · *mis-*

suffix : an *-ful, -*
ending *tion, -*
· *ly*

word family : all the words
from one base

part of speech : noun, verb,
adjective,
adverb

stress : the
strong syllable *phoTOgraphy*
·

Useful phrases for checking your own writing:

It needs a noun here.

That slot wants an adjective.

Add -ly for the adverb.

The meaning is negative.

What's the base word?

Does the stress move?

GRAMMAR BOX

un + success + ful + ly = unsuccessfully · prefix = meaning · suffix = the job

Base	Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
decide	decision	decide	decisive	decisively
success	success	succeed	successful	successfully
strength	strength	strengthen	strong	strongly
economy	economy / economics	economize	economic / economical	economically

The ending tells you the job:

Noun	-tion / -sion · -ment · -ness · -ity · -er / -or	education · agreement · kindness · ability · actor
Adjective	-ful · -less · -able / -ible · -ive · -ous · -al	hopeful · hopeless · reliable · creative · famous · natural
Adverb	-ly	quickly · easily · carefully (-ful has one l, -fully has two)

Verb	-ize · -en · -ify	modernize · widen · simplify
-------------	-------------------	------------------------------

Prefixes change the meaning, not the job:

Negative	un- · in- · im- (before m, p) · il- (before l) · ir- (before r) · dis- · non-	unfair · incorrect · impossible · illegal · irregular · dishonest · non-smoker
Other	re- again · over- too much · under- too little · mis- wrongly · pre- before	rewrite · overwork · underpaid · misunderstand · preview

⚠ Careful: **invaluable** = extremely valuable (not "worthless"). *flammable* = *inflammable*. Don't invent words: there is no "beautiless."

To fill a gap: (1) What **job** does the slot need? (2) **Build** the form, and check: positive or negative? singular or plural?

💡 🗣 WHERE'S THE STRESS? LISTEN AND UNDERLINE THE STRONG SYLLABLE.

1. photograph · photography · photographic · photographer
2. economy · economic · economist
3. create · creation · creative · creativity
4. educate · education
5. compete · competition · competitive
6. decide · decision · decisive

What happens to the stress before **-tion**, **-ic** and **-ity**? _____

💡 👥 ✎ EXERCISE 1 – THE WORD FAMILY GRID

Work with a partner. You have card A or B. Ask, answer and spell: "What's the adjective from *rely*?" "*Reliable*: R-E-L-I-A-B-L-E." Then agree on the negative together. Some cells have no word: write —.

Base	Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb	Negative
decide					
succeed					
create *					
strong					
compete					
rely					
care					

attract					
employ *					
responsible					

* These families have more than one noun. What's the difference? _____

 EXERCISE 2 – FORM THE CORRECT WORD

Change the word in CAPITALS so it fits the gap.

1. The new bridge was a huge _____ (SUCCESS).
2. She is one of the most _____ (CREATE) people I know.
3. He explained the plan very _____ (CLEAR).
4. They need to _____ (STRONG) the team before the final.
5. Unfortunately, the first attempt was a complete _____ (FAIL).
6. The instructions were full of useful _____ (INFORM).
7. Thank you. Your advice was really _____ (HELP).
8. The city plans to _____ (MODERN) the old train station.

 EXERCISE 3 – ADD THE RIGHT NEGATIVE PREFIX

Write **un-**, **in-**, **im-**, **il-**, **ir-**, **dis-** or **non-**.

1. It's simply _____ possible to finish it by Friday.
2. Parking here is _____ legal: you'll get a ticket.
3. I completely _____ agree with that decision.
4. His handwriting is almost _____ readable.
5. Leaving the kids alone was totally _____ responsible.
6. The answer he gave was clearly _____ correct.
7. She's a _____ -smoker, so she's happy about the new rule.
8. The bus was late again. It's so _____ reliable!

 EXERCISE 4 – OTHER PREFIXES: **RE-**, **OVER-**, **UNDER-**, **MIS-**, **PRE-**

1. I _____ understood the time and arrived an hour early.
2. The chicken was _____ cooked: still pink inside.
3. My first draft was messy, so I had to _____ write the report.
4. Many nurses are _____ worked and very tired.

5. Let's watch the _____ view of the movie before we buy tickets.

6. He _____ spelled my name on the certificate.

7. Some workers are _____ paid for the hours they do.

 EXERCISE 5 – A COMEBACK STORY. COMPLETE IT WITH THE RIGHT FORM.

Last spring, Rosa and Sam opened a taco truck. Despite careful (1) _____ (PREPARE), the first month was a complete (2) _____ (FAIL). Customers found the menu (3) _____ (CONFUSE), and the prices were (4) _____ (REASON): far too high. The team felt (5) _____ (DISAPPOINT), but they acted (6) _____ (DECIDE). They made several key (7) _____ (IMPROVE): a shorter menu and lower prices. Then they waited (8) _____ (PATIENT). Today the truck is a real (9) _____ (SUCCEED), and they have three (10) _____ (EMPLOY).

 Label each answer: N, V, ADJ or ADV.

 DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

Tutor: Your essay is strong, but look at this line: "The city should modern the railroads."

Student: Oh, that slot needs a verb, doesn't it? So... *modernize* the railroads.

Tutor: Exactly. And here you wrote "a decide leader." What job does that slot need?

Student: It's before a noun, so an adjective: a *decisive* leader. And if I meant the opposite, *indecisive*.

Tutor: Perfect. One more: "The project was a success, and we finished it success."

Student: That describes how we finished, so it's an adverb: *successfully*.

Tutor: You didn't learn any new words today. You just reshaped the ones you already had.

 Find two more sentences in your own writing (or a text from class) and "reshape" one word in each.

 SPEAKING – THE COMEBACK STORY

 Tell a short story (about 1 minute) about something that went wrong and then went right: a scenario card, a light real story, or something imagined. Use **at least six forms** from the word families. Your group marks the forms they hear on their bingo grid.

 **My six forms** (write key words only, not full sentences):

What went wrong?	
What did they / I do?	
How did it end?	
My six forms	

 **My word family map** (homework): six bases that are useful for you. Mark the stress.

Base	Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb	Negative

◆ 🔊 SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

"She handled the crisis very ____." The gap describes *how* she handled it. Which form fits?

A) decision

B) decisive

C) decisively

2

Which negative form of *responsible* is correct?

A) unresponsible

B) irresponsible

C) imresponsible

3

"Thank you so much. Your help was ____ ." You want to say it was extremely useful. Which word fits?

A) valueless

B) invaluable

C) unvaluable

◆ ✅ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ build a word family: noun, verb, adjective, adverb and a negative
- ◆ ☐ tell a word's job from its ending (-tion, -ful, -ly, -ize...)
- ◆ ☐ choose the right negative prefix: un-, in-, im-, il-, ir-, dis-, non-
- ◆ ☐ decide what job a gap needs, then build the form

- ◆ □ hear and say the stress when it moves (phoTOgraphy)

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write two sentences, each using two members of the same family ("It was a brave decision, and she made it decisively."). Underline the endings.

NEW WORDS — WEIGHING OPTIONS

value for money : worth the price

reliable : works well every time

a commute : the trip to work

the cost of living : rent, food, bills

a trend : a change that continues

a warranty : the store's promise to repair

Useful phrases for comparing and recommending:

far / much better than...

slightly cheaper than...

not nearly as good as...

nowhere near as...

twice as expensive as...

the same as...

the more..., the better

getting better and better

So overall, I'd recommend...

GRAMMAR BOX

How big is the difference? Put a word in front of the comparative:

Big difference	far / much / a lot / considerably / significantly + comparative	This laptop is far more powerful than my old one.
Small difference	slightly / a bit / a little / marginally + comparative	The blue jacket is slightly cheaper.
Much less	not nearly as / nowhere near as + adjective + as	The movie was nowhere near as good as the book.
Almost as	not quite as + adjective + as	The bus isn't quite as fast as the train.

✗ very cheaper · very more expensive → ✓ **much** cheaper · **far** more expensive (very only with a plain adjective: very expensive)

Equal	as + adjective / adverb + as	He works as hard as anyone.
Multiples	twice / three times / half as... as	Their house is three times as big as ours.
Same / similar	the same as · similar to · different from	Your phone is the same as mine.
Than or as?	-er / more / less → than · as / the same → as	bigger than · as big as

Two changes together	The + comparative..., the + comparative...	The more you practice, the better you get. · The sooner, the better.
A trend	comparative and comparative · more and more + long adjective	Her English is getting better and better. · Rent is getting more and more expensive.
Actions	more quickly · more carefully · faster · harder · better	She types more quickly than I do. (never "more faster")

✦ ✎ EXERCISE 1 – COMPLETE THE COMPARISON

1. This phone is much _____ (cheap) than the other one.
2. She isn't _____ tall as her sister.
3. The train is twice _____ fast as the bus.
4. My new job pays the same _____ my old one.
5. The weather is getting warmer and _____.
6. This exercise is a bit _____ (hard) than the last one.
7. The new version is similar _____ the old one, but it's different _____ the first.
8. Please drive _____ (careful). The roads are icy.

✦ ✎ EXERCISE 2 – THE MORE..., THE MORE...

Remember: **two** "the"s and **two** comparatives.

1. The more you read, _____ you learn.
2. _____ (hard) you work, the luckier you get.
3. The sooner we start, the _____ (good).
4. The older he gets, the _____ he worries.
5. The _____ (big) the crowd, the more nervous she felt.
6. The earlier we leave, the _____ traffic we'll hit.

🗣️ Now finish these about your life (or your identity card): The more I... · The less I... · The earlier I...

✦ 🗣️ EXERCISE 3 – HOW BIG IS THE DIFFERENCE?

Listen to six sentences. Circle the size of the difference.

1	big · small · much less · almost the same · equal
2	big · small · much less · almost the same · equal
3	big · small · much less · almost the same · equal

4	big · small · much less · almost the same · equal
5	big · small · much less · almost the same · equal
6	big · small · much less · almost the same · equal

 Which word told you the answer? Write it next to each line.

 EXERCISE 4 – REWRITE IT

1. The new model is better than the old one. (add a strong intensifier) → _____
2. The blue jacket is a little cheaper than the black one. (use *slightly*) → _____
3. When you sleep more, you feel better. (use *the more..., the better*) → _____
4. The movie was much worse than the book. (use *not nearly as... as*) → _____
5. The Kestrel costs \$640. The Nova costs \$320. (use *twice as... as*) → _____
6. Rent goes up every year. (use *more and more*) → _____

 EXERCISE 5 – FIND THE MISTAKE. WRITE THE CORRECT SENTENCE.

1. This one is very cheaper. → _____
2. Your bag is the same than mine. → _____
3. He runs more faster than his brother. → _____
4. Millbrook is smaller as Riverton. → _____
5. More you try, better it gets. → _____
6. The Kestrel is twice more expensive as the Nova. → _____

 DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

A: So, which route do you recommend: the highway or the coast road?

B: The highway is far quicker, but honestly, it's nowhere near as pretty. The coast road is twice as long, though.

A: Hmm. The earlier we leave, the less traffic we'll hit, right?

B: Exactly. And the coast road gets more and more beautiful the farther south you go. It's slightly slower, but I think it's worth it.

A: And gas? Doesn't the long way cost a lot more?

B: Only a little more. It's not quite as cheap, but it's the same car, the same trip, and a much better view.

A: OK, you've convinced me. Let's take the coast road. The earlier we set off, the better!

 Underline every comparison. How many different structures can you find? _____

 SPEAKING – COMPARE & RECOMMEND

 You and your partner have facts about two different options (two phones, two jobs, or two towns). Don't show your sheet: tell your partner, compare, then read a **client card** and agree on a recommendation. End with: "So overall, I'd recommend... because..."

 Tick each structure when you use it:

☐ far / much / considerably + comparative	☐ slightly / a bit + comparative
☐ not nearly / nowhere near as... as	☐ twice / three times / half as... as
☐ the more..., the more...	☐ more and more / better and better

 **My recommendation** (homework, 6–8 sentences): _____

 SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which sentence is correct?

A) This one is very more expensive.

B) This one is far more expensive.

C) This one is more expensive as that.

2

Complete: "___ you practice, the more confident you become."

A) The more

B) More

C) The much

3

The Nova costs \$320. The Kestrel costs \$640. Which sentence is correct?

A) The Kestrel is twice more expensive than the Nova.

B) The Kestrel is twice as expensive than the Nova.

C) The Kestrel is twice as expensive as the Nova.

◆  I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ say how big a difference is: far / much / slightly / a bit + comparative
- ◆ ☐ use not nearly as... as, nowhere near as... as and not quite as... as
- ◆ ☐ use twice as... as, the same as, and choose than or as
- ◆ ☐ link two changes: the more..., the more...
- ◆ ☐ describe a trend: better and better, more and more expensive
- ◆ ☐ compare two options and make a clear recommendation

◆  MY NEW WORDS

◆  MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Compare two things in your week: one with a big difference (*far / much*) and one with a small difference (*slightly / a bit*).

NEW WORDS — AT THE FRONT DESK

the front desk / reception

an inquiry : a question to a business

a membership : you pay to join

availability : free times or places

to confirm : to check it's true

an opener : *Could you tell me...?*

Openers, from casual to careful:

Do you know...?

Could you tell me...?

Do you have any idea...?

Would you mind telling me...?

I was wondering if...

I'd like to know...

GRAMMAR BOX

Indirect questions: opener + **statement word order**. No *do / does / did*.

Direct	Indirect
Where is the station?	Could you tell me where the station is ?
What time does it open?	Do you know what time it opens ?
How much did it cost?	Could you tell me how much it cost ?
Are they open on Sundays?	Do you know if they're open on Sundays?
Does the bus stop here?	I was wondering whether the bus stops here.

or not: whether **or not** they're open · if they're open **or not** (not "if or not")

Negative questions show what you already think or feel:

Agree with me!	Isn't it beautiful? ↘
I'm surprised	Didn't you get my message? ↗
I think so: check	Isn't the office closed on Mondays? ↗
Suggest / persuade	Don't you think we should wait? ↘ · Wouldn't it be easier to fly? ↘

Answer by the facts: "Didn't you get my message?" I got it → **Yes, I did.** · I didn't → **No, I didn't.**

Subject question (no auxiliary)	Object question (do / does / did)
Who saw you? (someone saw you)	Who did you see? (you saw someone)
Who broke the window?	What did she break?
What happened next?	What does this mean?

 **Sound polite:** start a little higher, use your whole voice, and let an indirect question **rise gently** at the end ↗. A flat, low voice sounds bored, even with perfect grammar.

 EXERCISE 1 – THE FRONT-DESK CALL

Listen to a phone call to the Riverside Community Center. What does the caller want?

Listen again. Write the **six** questions the caller asks (the part after the opener is enough).

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

 EXERCISE 2 – MAKE IT INDIRECT. COMPLETE THE GAP.

1. "Where is the museum?" → Could you tell me where the museum _____?
2. "What time does it open?" → Do you know what time it _____?
3. "How much did it cost?" → Could you tell me how much it _____?
4. "Are they open today?" → Do you know _____ they are open today?
5. "Does the bus stop here?" → I was wondering _____ the bus stops here.
6. "Why did she leave?" → Do you have any idea why she _____?

 EXERCISE 3 – REWRITE AS POLITE QUESTIONS. USE THE OPENER.

1. "Where is the nearest bank?" (Could you tell me...) → _____
2. "What time does the movie start?" (Do you know...) → _____
3. "Is this seat free?" (I was wondering...) → _____
4. "How long does the trip take?" (Would you mind telling me...) → _____
5. "When will my sofa arrive?" (Do you have any idea...) → _____

6. "Do you deliver on weekends?" (Could you tell me... + or not) → _____

 EXERCISE 4 – NEGATIVE QUESTIONS

A. Complete the negative question.

1. _____ you get my email? I sent it yesterday. (surprise, past)
2. _____ this a wonderful view? (admire, present)
3. You want to suggest the train. → _____ easier to take the train?
4. You think the store closes at six. Check it. → _____ at six?

B. Answer by the facts. Use a short answer.

5. "Didn't you lock the door?" (You locked it.) → _____
6. "Haven't you met Sara?" (You haven't met her.) → _____
7. "Isn't the bank open today?" (It's closed.) → _____
8. "Don't you like coffee?" (You love it.) → _____

 Say 1–4 with a partner. Rise ↗ or fall ↘? Your partner answers.

 EXERCISE 5 – SUBJECT OR OBJECT? THE OFFICE MYSTERY

Listen to the story. Then write the question for the **bold** part.

1. **Leo** opened the fridge at nine. → _____
2. The team bought **a chocolate cake**. → _____
3. **Something strange** happened at twelve. → _____
4. Ms. Tran called **her manager**. → _____
5. **Mr. Obi** called a meeting. → _____
6. Who _____ (break) the window? • 7. What _____ (happen) at the meeting?

 DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

Staff: Good morning, Lakeview Community College. How can I help you?

Caller: Hi. I was wondering if you still had places in the evening computer class.

Staff: Let me check... Yes, we have four places left.

Caller: Great. Could you tell me when the class starts?

Staff: On October sixth, Tuesdays and Thursdays from six to eight.

Caller: And do you know how much it costs?

Staff: It's \$180 for ten weeks. Didn't you see the price on our website?

Caller: No, I didn't. I couldn't find it. Would you mind telling me whether I need to take a test first?

Staff: No test for this class. Don't you think it would be easier to register online, though? It only takes five minutes.

Caller: Maybe, but isn't it better to pay in person? I'd like a receipt.

Staff: Of course. You can come in any weekday before five.

 Circle the indirect questions. Underline the negative questions. Mark ↗ or ↘ on each negative question.

 SPEAKING – POLITE ENQUIRY ROLE-PLAY

 Groups of three: **A** = customer or job candidate, **B** = staff or interviewer, **C** = observer. Take a card. Plan with key words only (2 minutes), then play it. In the job interview, the candidate always uses an **identity card**.

 **My planner** (key words only):

Situation	
6 things I need to know	
My yes/no question (if / whether)	
My negative question	

 **Observer checklist:** ☐ 6 indirect questions · ☐ statement order · ☐ no do / does / did · ☐ if / whether · ☐ a negative question · ☐ polite voice ↗ · One thing that was great: _____ · One thing to fix: _____

 SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which indirect question is correct?

A) Could you tell me where does the station is?

B) Could you tell me where is the station?

C) Could you tell me where the station is?

2

Which is a correct subject question (the question word is the doer)?

A) Who broke the window?

B) Who did broke the window?

C) Who did break the window?

3

"Didn't you get my message?" You did get it. What do you say?

A) "No, I did."

B) "Yes, I did."

C) "Yes, I didn't."

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ ask a polite indirect question with statement word order: Could you tell me where it is?
- ◆ ☐ drop do / does / did and use if / whether for yes/no questions
- ◆ ☐ use negative questions to show surprise, agree, check or persuade
- ◆ ☐ answer a negative question by the facts: Yes, I did. / No, I didn't.
- ◆ ☐ ask subject questions with no auxiliary: Who called?
- ◆ ☐ sound polite with my voice as well as my words

◆  MY NEW WORDS

◆  MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write a question you really need to ask this week, first direct, then polite and indirect. Where would you use each one?

 HOMEWORK — MY REAL QUESTIONS

Write four direct questions you might really ask this week (at a store, a station, an office or online). Rewrite each one as an indirect question with a **different** opener. Then add one negative question and one subject question.

Communicating with Style

Good English isn't only correct; it fits. In this module you'll choose the right voice for a friend, a manager or a company, tell a story that keeps people listening, and make a case that can stand up to a tough question.

Lessons 7.1-7.3

Classes C20-C22

Level B2

Name: _____

ICONS

 Write ·  Listen ·  Say ·  Work with a partner ·  Read

Whenever a task asks about your life, you decide what to share. You can use a real experience, a **new identity card**, a prompt card, or something you invent. Nobody will ask which. You can always say "Pass."

NEW WORDS — TALKING ABOUT REGISTER



a text
(to a friend): *informal*
/ *casual*



an email
(to a manager): *neutral*



a formal
letter (to a company): *formal*

register = the level of formality you choose for the reader and the situation · **a set phrase** = a fixed expression (*I look forward to hearing from you*) · **a contraction** = *I'm, don't, won't* · **a sign-off** = the closing word before your name (*Sincerely,*) · **an inquiry** = a formal question or request for information (UK: *enquiry*) · **a complaint**

I am writing to inquire about...

I would be grateful if you could...

I was wondering whether...

Would it be possible to...?

Unfortunately,...

I look forward to hearing from you.

Please do not hesitate to contact me.

GRAMMAR BOX — THE FOUR FEATURES THAT SHIFT

Feature	Informal	Formal
1 Word choice	ask for · get · find out · put off · need · tell · help · but · so	request · obtain / receive · discover · postpone · require · inform · assist · however · therefore
2 Contractions	I'm · haven't · won't	I am · have not · will not
3 Sentences	The heater's broken. It's really cold. Can someone come?	As the heating is no longer working and the apartment has become extremely cold, I would appreciate it if a technician could visit as soon as possible.
4 Set phrases	Hi Sam, · Just wondering... · Can you...? · Let me know. · Thanks!	Dear Mr. Clarke: · I am writing to inquire about... · I would be grateful if you could... · I look forward to hearing from you. · Sincerely,

Polite speech uses distance: *Could you...? · Would you mind + -ing? · I was wondering whether I could... · Would it be possible to...?* (Contractions are fine when you *speak* formally.)

The formal email	① Greeting → ② Reason for writing → ③ Detail → ④ Request / action → ⑤ Closing line + sign-off
US sign-off	Sincerely, (or <i>Best regards,</i>) after any greeting. <i>Dear Mr. Clarke:</i> or <i>Dear Mr. Clarke,</i>

⚠ **One register per message.** Don't open with "Dear Sir or Madam" and close with "Cheers!"

🔹 ✎ EXERCISE 1 – TURN THE DIAL UP. WRITE THE FORMAL WORD.

1. ask for → _____ 2. put off → _____ 3. find out → _____
 4. need → _____ 5. get (a letter) → _____ 6. tell (someone) → _____
 7. help → _____ 8. but → _____ 9. so → _____

🔹 📖 ✎ EXERCISE 2 – INFORMAL, NEUTRAL OR FORMAL? CIRCLE I, N OR F.

1. Gimme a call when you're free. I · N · F
 2. Could you let me know when you have a moment? I · N · F
 3. I would be grateful if you could reply at your earliest convenience. I · N · F
 4. Thanks so much, see you Friday! I · N · F
 5. Unfortunately, the item did not match the description on your website. I · N · F
 6. Just checking: are we still on for lunch? I · N · F
 7. I'm afraid I won't be able to make the meeting on Tuesday. I · N · F
 8. Please do not hesitate to contact me should you require further information. I · N · F

🔹 ✎ EXERCISE 3 – COMPLETE THE INQUIRY EMAIL.

Use: *grateful · inquire · Sincerely · hearing · available · Dear · Unfortunately · attached*

(1) _____ Admissions Team,

I am writing to (2) _____ about the evening first-aid course advertised on your website.

I work full time, so I am only (3) _____ after 6 p.m. (4) _____, the website does not say whether the course runs in the evening in March.

I would be (5) _____ if you could send me the dates and the cost. I have (6) _____ a copy of my current certificate for your reference.

I look forward to (7) _____ from you.

(8) _____,

Daniel Okafor

🔹 🗣️ ✎ EXERCISE 4 – SOFTEN THE REQUEST. YOU'RE SPEAKING TO A MANAGER OR A STRANGER.

Example: "Move my appointment." → **I was wondering whether I could move my appointment.**

1. "Give me Friday off." → Would it be possible _____

2. "Send me the schedule." → Could you _____
3. "Explain this form to me." → Would you mind _____
4. "I want to leave early today." → I was wondering whether _____
5. "Put me near a window." → Would it be possible _____

 EXERCISE 5 – REWRITE ANA'S TEXT AS AN EMAIL TO HER MANAGER.

 Ana sent this to her friend at work. Now she needs to send the same message to her manager, Mr. Patel. Keep it polite and professional (neutral to formal): a greeting, the reason, the detail, a request, a sign-off. No contractions.

hey!! can't do my sat shift, family stuff 🙄 maria said she'll cover tho. can u tell dan for me? thx!!! – A

 DIALOGUE – TWO VOICES, THE SAME REQUEST

Ana: Hey Sam, got a sec? Any chance you could swap shifts with me on Saturday?

Sam: Yeah, no problem. I'll take your morning, you take my Sunday?

Ana: Deal. You're a lifesaver!

Ana: Excuse me, Mr. Patel. Do you have a moment?

Mr. Patel: Of course, Ana. What can I do for you?

Ana: I was wondering whether it might be possible to swap my Saturday shift with Sam. He's already agreed to cover it.

Mr. Patel: That should be fine. Could you send me a quick email so I can update the schedule?

Ana: Certainly. I'll send it this afternoon. Thank you very much.

 Find three things that make the second conversation more formal: _____

 SPEAKING – REGISTER SWITCH WORKSHOP

Your group gets a situation card. Write the **same message** three ways. Then read them aloud in any order. Can the class guess the reader?

A • Text to a friend	B • Email to a manager	C • Formal letter to an organization

Checklist for the checker: ☐ word choice ☐ contractions ☐ sentence length ☐ set phrases ☐ one register all the way through

💡 SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

You're writing to a British company and you began with "Dear Ms Ford,". Which sign-off follows the British rule?

A) Yours sincerely,

B) Yours faithfully,

C) Cheers,

2

Which sentence is the most appropriate for a formal email?

A) Hi, I just wanna know if you've got any spots left.

B) I am writing to inquire whether any places are still available.

C) Gimme the info when you can, thanks!

3

Which message mixes registers?

A) Hi Jo! Running late, save me a seat?

B) Dear Mr. Lee: I am writing to confirm my appointment on June 4. Sincerely, Mina Cho

C) Dear Ms. Ortiz, I am writing to request a copy of my contract. Thanks a bunch, see ya!

◆  I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ say whether a message is informal, neutral or formal, and why
- ◆ ☐ change word choice, contractions, sentence length and set phrases to move up or down the dial
- ◆ ☐ make a polite spoken request: *I was wondering whether...*
- ◆ ☐ write a five-part formal email with a matching sign-off
- ◆ ☐ write one message three ways without mixing registers

◆  MY NEW WORDS

◆  MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Take one casual message you sent this week and rewrite it formally. Which words did you change?

NEW WORDS — MAKING A STORY VIVID

Extreme adjectives go with **absolutely** or **really**, not *very*:



very
angry
→ **absolutely
furious**



very
excited
→ **absolutely
thrilled**



very
cold
→ **absolutely
freezing**



very
hot
→ **absolutely
boiling**



very
scared
→ **absolutely
terrified**

an anecdote = a short, true-sounding personal story · **a hook** = the first line that makes people want to listen
· **the punchline** = the funny or surprising last line · **a mix-up** = a confusing mistake · **a coincidence** · **soaked** = completely wet · **mortified** = extremely embarrassed

You'll never guess what happened...

So the other day...

This reminds me of the time...

Just as...

All of a sudden...

Before I knew it...

To cut a long story short...

And that's why...

GRAMMAR BOX — THE SHAPE OF A STORY

Open	a hook	You'll never guess what happened to me on the way to work.
Scene	past continuous (+ <i>when</i> + past simple)	I was waiting for the bus when it started to pour.
Backstory	past perfect	I'd just bought a new white jacket.
Build	connectors that control the pace	At first... · Then... · A few minutes later... · Just as I... · All of a sudden... · Before I knew it...
Climax	historic present · direct speech · emphasis	So I'm standing there, absolutely soaked, and this man goes, "Lovely weather!"
Land	an ending phrase, then stop	In the end... · To cut a long story short... · And that's why... · Lesson learned!

☞ In **spoken** stories, people often say *he goes*, "...", or *she was like*, "...", instead of *said*. Use them only in casual speech.

 **Listener reactions:** No way! · You're kidding! · Oh no! · Then what? · What did you do? · That's hilarious! · You must have been mortified!

 EXERCISE 1 – ORDER THE ANECDOTE. WRITE 1-6.

- _____ a) All of a sudden, the whole cake slid off the plate and onto the floor.
- _____ b) So last Saturday I was carrying a birthday cake into my sister's party.
- _____ c) To cut a long story short, we ate ice cream instead, and that's why I always use a box now.
- _____ d) The funniest thing happened to me last weekend.
- _____ e) At first, everything was fine. Everyone was singing.
- _____ f) Just as I reached the table, the dog ran between my feet.

 EXERCISE 2 – CIRCLE THE BEST CONNECTOR.

1. **At first** / **Before I knew it**, the new job seemed easy.
2. **Just as** / **In the end** I sat down to eat, my phone rang.
3. I waited and waited. **A few minutes later** / **Just as**, the manager came out.
4. Everything was quiet. **All of a sudden** / **At first**, the fire alarm went off.
5. I started chatting to a stranger on the train, and **before I knew it** / **at first**, I'd missed my stop.
6. **In the end** / **Just as**, everything worked out fine.

 EXERCISE 3 – COMPLETE THE STORY WITH THE RIGHT PAST FORM.

Use the verb in brackets: past continuous, past simple or past perfect.

It (1) _____ (rain) and I (2) _____ (walk) to the train station. I (3) _____ (just / buy) a coffee, so I was holding it carefully. Just as I (4) _____ (get) to the platform, a man (5) _____ (run) up and gave me a huge hug. Coffee went everywhere. Then he (6) _____ (step) back and said, "Oh! You're not Mike!" He (7) _____ (think) I was his best friend. In the end, he bought me a new coffee and we (8) _____ (laugh) about it all the way into town.

 EXERCISE 4 – MAKE IT STRONGER. USE *ABSOLUTELY* + AN EXTREME ADJECTIVE.

Use: *furious* · *exhausted* · *starving* · *terrified* · *thrilled* · *freezing*

1. I hadn't eaten all day. I was _____
2. I got the job! I was _____
3. It was minus ten outside. It was _____
4. I'd worked a double shift. I was _____
5. The spider was huge. I was _____
6. They canceled my flight without telling me. I was _____

◆ 🗣️ ✎ EXERCISE 5 – BE A GOOD LISTENER. WRITE A NATURAL REACTION.

1. "So I opened the box, and it was completely empty." → _____
2. "...and then I realized I'd been talking to the wrong person the whole time." → _____
3. "Guess who I bumped into at the airport? My old teacher from elementary school!" → _____
4. "Anyway, that's the story of how I ended up on live TV." → _____

◆ 📖 🗣️ DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER. PERFORM IT!

Priya: You'll never guess what happened to me on the way to the interview this morning.

Tom: Go on. What happened?

Priya: So I was running a bit late, and I was wearing my best suit. At first everything was fine. Then, just as I was crossing the street, a bus drove straight through a huge puddle.

Tom: Oh no!

Priya: All of a sudden I'm absolutely soaked, head to toe. And this old man just looks at me and goes, "Lovely weather for it!"

Tom: No way! What did you do?

Priya: Well, before I knew it, I was standing in reception, dripping on the floor and trying to smile. I've never been so embarrassed in my life.

Tom: You're kidding! So how did the interview go?

Priya: To cut a long story short, I got the job. And that's why I always carry an umbrella now. Lesson learned!

✎ Find: the hook · one line of scene-setting · the historic present · the direct speech · the ending. Underline them.

◆ 👥 SPEAKING – ANECDOTE CIRCLE: PLAN YOUR STORY (KEY WORDS ONLY!)

A true story, a prompt card, a new identity card, or an invented story: all are welcome.

1 Hook	
2 Scene (was ____ing)	
3 Events + connectors	

4 Climax: "...!" (direct speech)

5 Ending: In the end / And that's why...

 Tell it in 2 minutes.  Listeners: use two reactions and ask one follow-up question at the end.

  SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which phrase best opens a spoken anecdote?

A) In the end, I went home.

B) You'll never guess what happened to me.

C) And that's why I was late.

2

Your friend says, "...and when I looked in my bag, my wallet was gone." What's the most natural reaction?

A) Oh no! What did you do?

B) I see. That is interesting.

C) Anyway, what are you having for lunch?

3

Which sentence sets the scene for a story?

A) In the end, we all went home.

B) No way! That's hilarious!

C) I was waiting for the elevator when the fire alarm went off.

  I CAN...

-  ☐ open a story with a hook and set the scene with the past continuous
-  ☐ use different connectors to control the pace (not "and then... and then...")
-  ☐ bring the big moment alive with direct speech or the historic present

- ◆ ☐ use *absolutely* + extreme adjectives
- ◆ ☐ land a clear ending and react naturally when someone else tells a story

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Which story did you hear today that you'll remember? What made it work: the hook, the voice, the ending?

NEW WORDS — MAKING A CASE

a **pitch** = a short talk to persuade people to support an idea · a **claim** = what you want people to believe · **evidence** = facts, figures or examples that support a claim · a **signpost** = a phrase that tells listeners where you are in a talk · an **objection** = a reason someone disagrees · **to concede** = to admit the other side has a point · **to counter** = to answer back with a stronger point · a **call to action** = what you ask the audience to do · a **proposal**

Today I'll cover...

First, let's look at...

Moving on to...

Take, for example,...

The main advantage is...

Research suggests...

Admittedly,... That said,...

To sum up,...

That's a good question.

GRAMMAR BOX — THE MOVES OF A PERSUASIVE TALK

Signpost	Today I'll cover... · To begin with... · Moving on to... / That brings me to... · What's more... · For instance... · To sum up... / In conclusion...
Argue	The main advantage is... · There are two reasons for this. First,... Second,... · Research suggests / The figures show... · As a result,...
Rhetorical question	Wouldn't we all like a safer walk home? · Isn't that worth it?
Tripling	It's cheaper, faster and greener. · It saves time, saves money and saves stress.
Contrast	It's not a cost; it's an investment. · We can carry on as we are, or we can do something better.
Appeal	Think about your own commute. · Together, we can...
Concede → counter	Admittedly, it costs more at first; however, it pays for itself within a year. · While it's true that there are risks, the benefits clearly outweigh them.
Handle a question	That's a good question. · If I understand you correctly, you're asking... · Let me come back to that. · I don't have the exact figure, but I'll follow up. · Does that answer your question?

⚠ One connector is enough: ❌ *Although it's expensive, but...* ✅ *Although it's expensive, it...*

EXERCISE 1 — COMPLETE THE PRESENTATION PHRASES.

1. Today I'll _____ two main points. (introduce the talk)

2. To _____ with, let's look at the problem. (first point)
3. That _____ me to my second point. (move on)
4. _____, for example, the library in Oakdale. (give an example)
5. The figures _____ that use has doubled. (give evidence)
6. To _____ up, this is the best option we have. (conclude)

 EXERCISE 2 – NAME THE TECHNIQUE.

Write: **RQ** (rhetorical question) · **3** (tripling) · **C** (contrast) · **A** (appeal to the listener) · **CC** (concede and counter)

1. Who wouldn't want a shorter wait at the clinic? _____
2. It's not a problem; it's an opportunity. _____
3. The garden will be greener, safer and friendlier. _____
4. Of course, no plan is perfect; nevertheless, this is the best option available. _____
5. Imagine walking to your car at night and feeling completely safe. _____
6. We can keep complaining about it, or we can fix it. _____

 EXERCISE 3 – CONCEDE AND COUNTER. MATCH THE HALVES.

1. Admittedly, it will take some time to set up; _____
 2. While it's true that some staff prefer driving, _____
 3. There will probably be a few problems at first; _____
 4. Of course, some families may not use it. _____
 5. I understand that the budget is tight; _____
- a) However, the survey shows that 60% of families would. · b) however, this costs less than one month of repairs. · c) nevertheless, the other centers that tried it solved them within weeks. · d) that said, once it's running, it needs almost no work. · e) at least twelve people already cycle and have nowhere to park.

 EXERCISE 4 – HANDLING QUESTIONS. CIRCLE THE BEST RESPONSE.

1. "How much will this cost per year, exactly?" (You don't know.)
A) About a million, probably. B) That's a good question. I don't have the exact figure, but I'll follow up this week. C) Next question, please.
2. A long, confusing question.
A) If I understand you correctly, you're asking who would manage it? B) I don't understand you. C) Yes.
3. "Isn't this just a waste of money?"
A) No, you're wrong. B) Admittedly, it isn't free. That said, it would save us money on repairs. C) Maybe. I don't know.

4. You've just answered a question.

A) OK, bye. B) So, yeah. C) Does that answer your question?

 DIALOGUE – AFTER THE PITCH

Leila: To sum up, then, a community garden would turn an empty lot into a place that's greener, safer and friendlier. Wouldn't we all rather look at vegetables than trash? Thank you. I'm happy to take questions.

Panelist: Who's actually going to take care of it in the summer, when people are away?

Leila: That's a good question. Admittedly, summer is the hardest time. That said, eighteen families have already signed up, and we'd set up a watering schedule, one week each.

Panelist: And what would it cost the neighborhood?

Leila: I don't have the final figure yet, but the first estimate is under two thousand dollars. I'll send the details to the board this week. Does that answer your question?

Panelist: It does, thank you. I hadn't thought about the schedule.

 Underline Leila's tripling, her rhetorical question, and her concede-counter move.

 SPEAKING – THE PITCH PANEL: TEAM PLANNER (KEY WORDS ONLY)

Our topic: _____

Speaker 1 · Signpost + the problem	Today we'll cover... The problem is...
Speaker 2 · The solution + evidence + a technique	Our proposal is... The main advantage is... Take, for example,...
Speaker 3 · Concede-counter + close + call to action	Admittedly,... That said,... To sum up,... So we're asking you to...
Two questions the panel might ask + our answers	

 Pitch: 2 minutes. Then 2 minutes of questions. Start every answer calmly: "That's a good question."

 SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which sentence best concedes and counters an objection?

A) Admittedly, it's expensive; however, it saves money long-term.

B) This is simply the best option, period.

C) Yes, it's expensive, and that's a real problem.

2

Someone asks a question and you're not sure of the answer. What's the most professional response?

A) Make up a confident-sounding figure on the spot.

B) "That's a good question. I don't have the exact figure, but I'll follow up."

C) Ignore it and move straight to your conclusion.

3

"It's not a cost; it's an investment." Which technique is this?

A) Tripling

B) Contrast

C) A rhetorical question

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ signpost a talk so the audience always knows where they are
- ◆ ☐ support a claim with a reason and evidence (a figure or an example)
- ◆ ☐ use a rhetorical question, tripling, contrast and an appeal to the listener
- ◆ ☐ concede a point and then counter it
- ◆ ☐ handle a question calmly, even when I don't know the answer

◆  MY NEW WORDS

◆  MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Which pitch persuaded you most today, and which move made the difference?

MODULE 7 — WELL DONE! 🎉

You can now choose the right voice for the reader, tell a story people want to hear, and make a case that holds up under questions. Look at your three "I can..." lists. Is a box still empty? Tell your teacher. Practice at home with online lessons 7.1, 7.2 and 7.3 and the 🗣️ buttons. Keep your pitch notes: you'll use these skills again in the Module 8 debate.

Fluency & the Final Project

The last module of B2. Train your ears to catch fast, natural English.

Learn when being approximate sounds natural, and when it just sounds careless. Then bring the whole level together in a real, formal debate.

Lessons 8.1–8.3

Classes C23–C25

Level B2

Name: _____

INSTRUCTIONS

 Write •  Listen •  Say •  Work with a partner •  Read

When a task is about your life, it's **your** choice what to share: your real life, a **new identity card**, or something invented. In the debate, your side is **drawn from a card**. It says nothing about what you really think. You can always say "Pass."

◆ KEY TERMS — HOW FAST ENGLISH REALLY SOUNDS



weak form: "a
cup of tea" →
"a cuppa tea"



weak form:
"fish and
chips" → "fish
'n' chips"



linking: "grab
a coffee" →
"gra-ba-
coffee"



elision:
"sandwich" →
"san(d)wich"

stress-timed

content word

grammar word

the schwa /ə/

weak form

linking

elision

assimilation

reduction

Stress-timed = the important words (nouns, main verbs, adjectives) get the beat and stay clear; the small grammar words between them get squeezed. The information is all still there. It's just wearing a disguise.

◆ GRAMMAR BOX — THE FOUR DISGUISES

1 • Weak forms. Small grammar words usually shrink to the schwa /ə/ ("uh").

to	/tə/	I want tə go.
of	/əv/ or /ə/	a cup ə tea · kind ə cold
and	/ən/ or /n/	fish 'n' chips
for	/fər/	It's fər you.
was · are	/wəz/ · /ər/	She wəz late. · They ər ready.
them	/ðəm/ or 'em	Tell 'em .
can ≠ can't	/kən/ short · /kænt/ long, stressed	I kən go. ≠ I CAN'T go.

2 • Linking. A final consonant jumps onto the next vowel: turn_it_off → "tur-ni-toff." Between two vowels you hear a tiny /w/ or /y/: go (w) on · I (y) agree.

3 • Elision & assimilation. Sounds disappear (next day · sandwich · most people) or blend (don't you → "doncha" · did you → "didja").

4 • Reductions.

gonna	going to	d'you	do you
wanna	want to	whatcha	what are you / what do you

gotta	(have) got to	lemme · gimme	let me · give me
kinda · sorta	kind of · sort of	dunno	don't know

⚠ These spellings only show the **sound**. When you **write**, always use the full form: *going to*, *want to*, *kind of*.

🎧 EXERCISE 1 – CAN OR CAN'T?

Your teacher reads eight sentences at natural speed. Write **can** or **can't**. Listen for the short /kən/ or the long, stressed /kænt/, not for the *t*.

- I _____ come on Friday.
- She _____ drive a truck.
- We _____ meet after work.
- They _____ find the keys.
- You _____ park behind the building.
- He _____ speak Spanish, but he _____ speak Portuguese.
- I _____ help you with that.
- We _____ hear you. _____ you speak up?

✎ EXERCISE 2 – EXPAND THE RELAXED FORM

Write each sentence the way you would **write** it.

- I'm gonna call her tonight. → _____
- D'you wanna come with us? → _____
- I've gotta finish this report. → _____
- It's kinda cold in here. → _____
- Whatcha doing this weekend? → _____
- Lemme see. Gimme a second. → _____
- I dunno. Ask 'em. → _____
- Didja see the game? → _____

🎧 EXERCISE 3 – FIND THE HIDDEN SOUNDS

A. Each phrase hides one weak or dropped sound. Write the missing grammar word or letter.

- "a cup ___ tea" _____
- "I want ___ go" _____
- "She ___ late" (past of *is*) _____
- "I ___ go" (the positive, quick modal) _____
- "fish 'n' chips" _____
- "nex() day" _____
- "It's ___ you." (a present) _____
- "Tell ___ I'm late." ('em) _____

B. Draw where the words link. Cross out the letter you **don't** hear. Then say each phrase to a partner.

1. turn it off · 2. pick it up · 3. an apple · 4. this evening · 5. far away

6. next day · 7. sandwich · 8. most people · 9. last night · 10. friendship

◆ 🦟 ✎ EXERCISE 4 – MICRO-DICTATION

Your teacher reads each sentence **twice at natural speed**. Count the words on your fingers, then write the full sentence. Then you hear a slow version: check and correct.

1. _____ words: ____

2. _____ words: ____

3. _____ words: ____

4. _____ words: ____

5. _____ words: ____

6. _____ words: ____

✎ Which words did you miss? Circle them. Were they big words or small words?

◆ 🦟 👥 EXERCISE 5 – DICTOGLOSS: A VOICEMAIL FROM DANA

Dana, a coworker, leaves you a voicemail. (1) Listen once. Just listen. (2) Listen again and write only the **big, stressed words**. (3) Share your notes with a partner. (4) In a group, rebuild the whole message in correct, complete written English. (5) Compare with the original. Label each thing you missed: **WF** weak form · **L** linking · **E** elision · **R** reduction.

◆ MY NOTES (BIG WORDS ONLY)

◆ OUR MESSAGE (FULL, CORRECT ENGLISH)

◆ 📖 👤 DIALOGUE – NATURAL SPEED

Sam: Whatcha doing this weekend? D'you wanna grab a coffee?

Jo: I'd love to, but I've gotta finish this report. It's kinda due Monday.

Sam: Ah, no worries. Lemme know when you're free. I'm gonna be around all week.

Jo: Will do. Fish 'n' chips on Friday? My treat.

Sam: Sounds great. See ya then!

 Underline every reduction. Then write Sam's first two lines in full, careful English:

 Read it with a partner twice: once slowly and carefully, once at natural speed. Clap the stressed beats:
WHATcha **DO**ing this **WEEK**end?

 SPEAKING – DECODE IT

Work with a partner and your A/B card. **A** says six sentences naturally. **B** writes each one in full, then **answers it** like a real conversation ("D'you wanna grab lunch?" → writes *Do you want to grab lunch?* → says "Sure! Where?"). Swap.

I heard...	Full form	My answer
D'you wanna grab lunch?	Do you want to grab lunch?	Sure! Where?

 SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

You hear "I wz gonna call ya." What is the full, standard sentence?

A) I was going to call you.

B) I want to call you.

C) I will call you.

2

A speaker says a quick, unstressed /kən/ before "help." Which is most likely?

A) "I can help" (a weak, unstressed *can*)

B) "I can't help" (the negative)

C) "I could help" (a reduced *could*)

3

You hear "I dunno. Lemme check." What did the speaker say?

A) I don't know. Let me check.

B) I do now. Let me check.

C) I didn't know. Let me check.

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ listen for the stressed words and let the small words flow between them
- ◆ ☐ recognize weak forms (*to, of, and, for, was, can*) and hear *can* vs *can't*
- ◆ ☐ follow linking, and recognize dropped and blended sounds
- ◆ ☐ expand *gonna, wanna, gotta, kinda, d'you, whatcha* and write the full forms
- ◆ ☐ rebuild a short spoken message in correct written English

◆  MY NEW WORDS

◆  MY JOURNAL

Listen to two minutes of natural English this week.
Write three moments where a word "disappeared."
What were the full words, and which disguise caused it?

NEW WORDS — THREE JOBS FOR VAGUE LANGUAGE



"I picked up a
few things ...



... milk, bread
...



... that kind of
thing."

≈ 1 • **Approximate** a number, amount or time:

about

around

roughly

... or so

-ish

give or take

thirty-odd

a couple of

more or less



2 • **General nouns & placeholders** stand in for a list or a word you can't find:

stuff

things

and that kind of thing

and stuff like that

and so on

or something

and everything

the thingy



3 • **Hedges** soften a statement or an opinion:

sort of

kind of

a bit

a little

in a way

I guess

I suppose

to be honest

GRAMMAR BOX — WHERE THE WORDS GO

Before the number	about · around · roughly · a couple of · a few	There were about twenty people.
After the number	or so · give or take · -odd (after 20, 30, 100...)	Give me ten minutes or so · thirty-odd guests
Attached	-ish (times, ages, colors, some adjectives)	Let's meet at seven- ish .
End of a list	and that kind of thing · and so on · or something	pizza, snacks, that kind of thing
Before an adjective	sort of · kind of · a bit · a little	It's a bit expensive.
Whole sentence	in a way · I guess · I suppose	In a way , you're right.

stuff is uncountable: *a lot of stuff* ✓ · *many stuffs* ✗. **more or less** = almost ("It's more or less finished"), not "so-so."

 Be vague	chatting with friends · casual estimates · small talk · friendly messages · softening an opinion
 Be precise	medicine and dosages · safety instructions · deadlines · money, contracts, legal and financial papers · reports to a manager

EXERCISE 1 – INSERT THE VAGUE EXPRESSION

1. There were _____ fifty guests at the wedding. (approximately, before the number)
2. Let's meet at eight _____. (a suffix meaning "roughly")
3. We bought fruit, vegetables, and that kind of _____. (general noun)
4. The movie was _____ boring, honestly. (soften the adjective; two words)
5. I'll only be a couple _____ minutes.
6. We could order pizza or _____. (a vague alternative)
7. Thirty _____ people turned up, maybe thirty-four. (after a round number)
8. It'll take an hour, give or _____. (complete the set phrase)

EXERCISE 2 – SOFTEN THE OVER-PRECISE SENTENCE

1. Blunt: "This is expensive." → "This is _____ expensive." (two words)
2. Exact: "It lasted 32 minutes." → "It lasted about _____ an hour."
3. Blunt: "I disagree." → "I _____ see it differently." (two words, not *kind of*)
4. Exact: "There were 48 people." → "There were fifty, give or _____."
5. Blunt: "You're wrong." → "_____ that's true, but..." (three words meaning "partly")
6. Exact: "The work is 100% finished." → "The work is _____ finished." (three words meaning "almost")

EXERCISE 3 – NATURAL OR SLOPPY?

Read the situation and the sentence. Circle  **natural** or  **sloppy** (too vague for the situation, or too many placeholders). Rewrite every  sentence so it fits.

1. To a friend: "There were about thirty people at the party, give or take."  / 
2. On a medicine label: "Take two-ish tablets every four hours or so."  /  _____
3. Email to your manager: "The report's more or less done. I'll send it sevenish."  / 

4. Text to your roommate: "Can you grab milk, bread, and stuff like that?"  / 
5. Calling your landlord: "The thingy in the kitchen is kind of broken."  / 

6. At the doctor's: "It's a dull pain, sort of here, for about a week." ✓ / ✗

7. Job interview: "I've worked in retail for, like, five years or something." ✓ / ✗

8. In a meeting: "I kind of see it differently. Could we look at the costs again?" ✓ / ✗

✦ ✎ EXERCISE 4 – JUST RIGHT

A. Too robotic. Rewrite it for a friend, with at least three vague expressions.

"The trip takes 34 minutes. I bought 6 items at the store. It cost \$12.50. There were 19 people in line."

B. Too vague. Rewrite it for a new coworker so it is clear. Invent the details.

"So you put the stuff with the thingy near the whatsit, and then you kind of do the other thing, or something."

✦ 🗣️ ✎ EXERCISE 5 – TWO VOICEMAILS, ONE STORY

Leo has just moved to a new apartment. He leaves two voicemails: one to his friend Mia and one to his manager, Ms. Carter. Complete the table.

	To Mia (friend)	To Ms. Carter (manager)
How long the move took	_____	_____
What he moved	_____	_____
When he's back at work	_____	_____
Anything else	_____	_____

🗣️ Why doesn't Leo tell his manager about the boxes? Why does he give her exact times?

✦ 📖 🗣️ DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

Alex: So how was the party? Were there a lot of people?

Priya: Yeah, about thirty or so, give or take. It was kind of crowded, actually.

Alex: Nice. Did you eat there, or...?

Priya: We grabbed a few things: pizza, snacks, that kind of thing. Nothing fancy.

Alex: And what time did it finish?

Priya: Oh, midnight-ish? I left a bit early. I was sort of tired. We should do something next weekend, though. Bowling or something?

Alex: Definitely. I'm more or less free after Thursday.

 Find one example of each job: $\approx$ approximate _____ ·  general noun _____ ·  hedge

◆ SPEAKING – REGISTER SWITCH AND DESCRIBE IT NATURALLY

 **Register Switch:** take an A/B card. Tell the **same** facts twice: first to a friend (relaxed and vague), then to the person on the card (a manager, doctor, landlord or teacher: clear and precise). Your partner plays both listeners.

 **Describe It Naturally:** describe a place, a routine or a plan for 60–90 seconds (real, a new identity card, or invented). Plan to use one $\approx$, one  and one . Your listener asks one follow-up ("Roughly how far is it?" "What kind of stuff?").

My notes: $\approx$ _____  _____  _____

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A friend asks how many people came. Which reply sounds the most natural in casual speech?

A) Precisely thirty-one people attended.

B) About thirty or so, give or take.

C) Some, I don't know, whatever.

2

In which situation should you avoid vague language and be precise?

A) Writing dosage instructions on medicine

B) Telling a friend about your weekend

C) Gently disagreeing with someone

3

Which sentence uses vague language in a sloppy way?

A) Pass me the thingy, the remote.

B) I put the stuff with the thingy near the whatsit.

C) We talked about work and that kind of thing.

◆  I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ approximate numbers and times: *about twenty, seven-ish, ten minutes or so, give or take*
- ◆ ☐ use general nouns: *stuff, things, and that kind of thing, or something*
- ◆ ☐ soften an opinion: *a bit, sort of, in a way*
- ◆ ☐ tell natural vagueness from sloppy vagueness
- ◆ ☐ switch to precise language for a manager, doctor, landlord or safety instruction

◆  MY NEW WORDS

◆  MY JOURNAL

Write a chatty paragraph (4–6 sentences) about your typical week for a friend, with four vague expressions underlined. Then rewrite one sentence in a "robotic" style. How does it feel?

◆ HOW A FORMAL DEBATE WORKS

A **motion** is a statement to debate: "Phones should be switched off during family meals." The **Proposition** argues for it; the **Opposition** argues against it. Your side is **drawn from a card**.

Role	What you do	Time
 Chair	Opens and closes, calls each speaker, takes floor questions, runs the vote. Stays neutral.	whole debate
 Timekeeper	Shows the cards: 1 MINUTE LEFT · 15 SECONDS · TIME. Counts the votes.	whole debate
 Proposer ·  Opposer	Opening speech: state your side and give 2–3 arguments, each with a reason and an example.	2 min each
 Rebuttal speakers	Answer the other team's points: concede what's fair, then counter. Add a new point if there's time.	1½ min each
 The floor	Ask one short question to a named team.	4 min in total
 Summary speakers	Weigh the debate. No new arguments. Opposition first, Proposition last.	1 min each

The order: Chair opens → vote 1 → Proposer → Opposer → 1-min huddle → Proposition rebuttal → Opposition rebuttal → floor questions → Opposition summary → Proposition summary → vote 2 → Chair closes. **The secret vote** asks one thing: which team made the stronger case?

◆ LANGUAGE BANK — DEBATING MOVES

Opening	Madam / Mr. Chair, ladies and gentlemen... · We are here to argue that... · Our case rests on three points. · The strongest argument in favor is... · For these reasons, we urge you to support / oppose the motion.
Adding	What's more... · Furthermore... · Not only that, but... · A further point worth making is...
Conceding & countering	Admittedly... / It's true that... · That may be so, but... · While I accept that..., I still believe... · Even if that's the case,... · That said,...
Rebuttal	My opponent claimed that... However,... · That argument ignores... · The other side would have you believe... But...

Floor question	My question is for the proposition / opposition. · You said that... Could you explain...? · What would happen if...?
Concluding	Weighing it all up... · On balance, I'd argue that... · All things considered... · The evidence points to...

Concede before you counter. "No, you're wrong" is weak. "That's a fair point, and it's true that... However..." sounds reasonable and is far more persuasive. Attack ideas, never people.

◆ THE B2 TOOLKIT – PLANT THESE ON PURPOSE

Conditionals	predict a result	If this were introduced , costs would soar.
Impersonal passive	sound objective	It is widely accepted that...
The causative	describe arrangements	Companies would have the work done abroad.
Advanced comparison	weigh options	This is by far the more effective approach.
Cleft & inversion	add emphasis	What really matters is... · Not only does it cost more, but...
Indirect questions	raise an issue politely	We might ask whether this is fair .
Hedging & vague language	sound natural, not stiff	It's sort of a trade-off, in a way .

◆ 🗣️ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO A MODEL DEBATE

Motion: "*Cities should ban private cars from their centers.*" Listen and answer.

1. What is Maya's strongest argument in favor? _____
2. Which groups does Tom say a ban would hurt? _____
3. How does Maya answer Tom's objection? _____
4. What does Tom still question? _____
5. What condition does Maya attach to her conclusion? _____

✏️ Tick the moves you hear: ☐ The strongest argument in favor is... ☐ It is widely accepted that... ☐ Admittedly... ☐ That said... ☐ That's a fair point... However... ☐ Even so, we might ask whether... ☐ On balance, I'd argue...

◆ ✏️ EXERCISE 2 – MIXED B2 REVIEW

1. If the ban _____ introduced, prices would rise. (second conditional, *be*)
2. It is widely _____ that the policy has failed. (impersonal passive)

3. This solution is by _____ the most effective one available.
4. We should have the report _____ before we publish it. (causative, *check*)
5. What really _____ is whether people can afford it. (cleft sentence)
6. Not only _____ it cost more, but it also takes longer. (inversion)

◆ ✎ EXERCISE 3 – CORRECT THE MISTAKE

1. It should have done earlier. → It should have _____ earlier.
2. He is thought to steal the money last year. → He is thought to _____ the money last year.
3. I look forward to hear from you. → I look forward to _____ from you.
4. If I would have known, I'd have told you. → If I _____ known, I'd have told you.
5. The meeting lasted a bit exactly two hours. → The meeting lasted _____ two hours.
6. This is more cheaper than the other. → This is _____ than the other.

◆ ✎ EXERCISE 4 – CONCEDE AND COUNTER: MATCH

Motion: *"Remote work should be the default for office jobs."* Match each concession (1–5) with the best counter (a–e).

1. Admittedly, working from home saves time on the commute. _____
 2. It's true that some people feel lonely at home. _____
 3. While I accept that offices are expensive to run, _____
 4. That may be so for experienced staff, _____
 5. Even if meetings are easier in person, _____
- a) ...but new employees learn far more when they sit next to their team.
 - b) ...I still believe a shared space builds trust that no video call can replace.
 - c) ...most of them can be replaced by a short call or a clear email.
 - d) That said, many people use that time to work longer hours, not to rest.
 - e) However, a regular team day each week would solve that without forcing everyone back.

◆ ✎ 🗣️ EXERCISE 5 – FROM BLUNT TO BALANCED

Rewrite each rebuttal: concede first, then counter. Then say it with the fall-rise: "AdMITtedly..."

1. "No. Phones at dinner are fine." → _____
2. "Wrong. A four-day week costs too much." → _____
3. "That's a stupid idea. Kids need homework." → _____
4. "You're wrong about cars. People need them." → _____

◆ ✎ MY DEBATE PREP SHEET – KEY WORDS ONLY

Motion: _____

Our side (drawn): ☐ Proposition (for) ☐ Opposition (against) My role: ☐ opening ☐ rebuttal ☐ summary
☐ chair ☐ timekeeper ☐ floor

Our argument	Reason	Example / consequence	Who says it?
1			
2			
3			

Their likely argument	We concede...	...but we counter
1		
2		
3		

B2 toolkit I will plant: ☐ conditional ☐ impersonal passive ☐ *by far* / comparison ☐ cleft (*What really matters...*) ☐ *Not only* inversion ☐ hedge (*sort of, on balance*)

My first sentence: _____

My last sentence: _____

 My floor question (for the other debate): _____

 AFTER THE DEBATE – RUBRIC SELF-CHECK

Criterion	★★★	★★	★
1 · Structure & signposting	☐	☐	☐
2 · Arguments & support (reasons, examples)	☐	☐	☐
3 · Rebuttal: concede & counter	☐	☐	☐
4 · Range of B2 language	☐	☐	☐
5 · Accuracy & register	☐	☐	☐
6 · Fluency, delivery & interaction	☐	☐	☐

★ One thing I did well: _____

 One thing to work on at C1: _____

 SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which phrase best concedes a point and then counters it?

A) "While I accept that it's expensive, I still believe it's worth it."

B) "No, you're completely wrong about that."

C) "What's more, it would also save time."

2

A balanced argument should end with...

A) a reasoned conclusion that weighs both sides and takes a position.

B) no opinion at all, to stay perfectly neutral.

C) a repeat of only the arguments in favor.

3

In a formal debate, what does the rebuttal speaker mainly do?

A) introduces the motion and explains the rules

B) answers the other team's arguments, conceding what is fair and countering it

C) counts the votes at the end

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ follow a debate and notice how speakers concede and counter
- ◆ ☐ build a case for a side I was given: arguments, reasons, examples
- ◆ ☐ give a timed speech from notes, with signposting
- ◆ ☐ answer what the other team actually said
- ◆ ☐ ask and answer a floor question, or chair or time a debate
- ◆ ☐ use a conditional, a passive, a comparison, a cleft or inversion, and a hedge in one speech

◆  MY NEW WORDS

◆  MY FINAL B2 JOURNAL

Which B2 structure are you proudest of using well?
Which still needs work? Then write three sentences
about your debate: one argument for, one against,

and a conclusion, with a conditional and a concede-and-counter phrase.

MODULE 8 — AND CONFIDENT ENGLISH (B2) — COMPLETE! 🎉

You can follow fast, natural English, choose when to be vague and when to be exact, and argue a case in a formal debate. Look at all your "I can..." lists, from Module 1 to now. Is a box still empty? Tell your teacher. Keep practicing with the online lessons and their 🔊 buttons. Next class is the final assessment and our celebration, and after that, **Advanced English (C1)** is waiting.